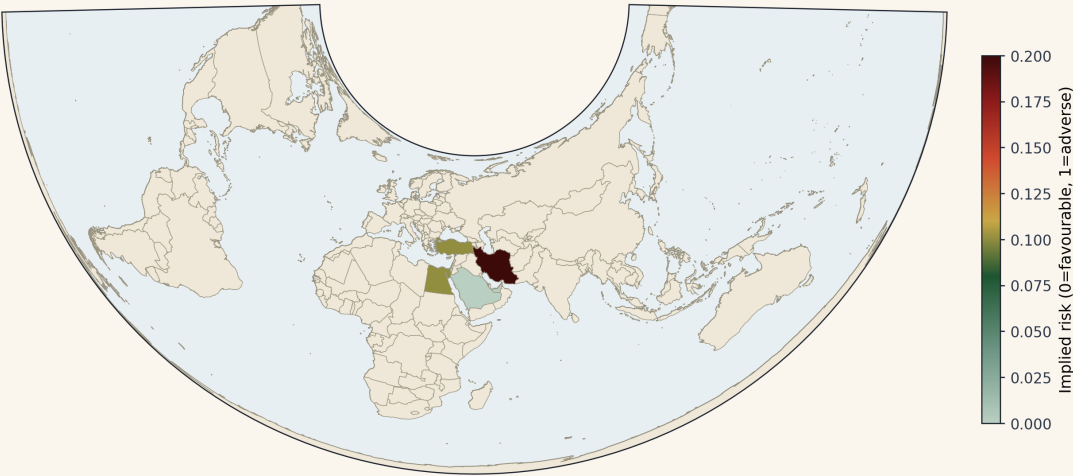


REGIONAL BRIEF

GIPRE Regional Brief — Greater Middle East

All-horizons regional outlook — May 2026

Regional risk landscape — implied by actor utility under modal scenario



Cooler = favourable; warmer = adverse. Derived from each actor agent's own utility under the top scenario.
Source: GIPRE 50-agent slice; agent utility outputs (May 2026).

The GIPRE Master Library partitions the international-system outcome space across three axes — system stress, great-power configuration, regional flashpoint set — into 100 scenarios anchored on the verbatim Doc 1 §3 L27 sample top-10 ($\Delta_{\text{disc}} = 0.97$). This v4 brief delivers narrative-integrated visuals at the point of argument, deep causal-chain analysis per top risk with historical analogues and counter-narratives, a dedicated tail-risk section, explicit Bayesian prior→posterior updates, and quantified business impacts.

100	6	10	5	\$113.8T
SCENARIOS	ACTORS	THEMES	LENSES	WORLD GDP 2025

Pre-registered falsification cycle. Q3-2025 baseline Brier: Vreeland 0.18, Mearsheimer 0.19, Reinhart-Rogoff 0.21.
Q1-2026 cycle starts from this brief.

01

Bottom Line Up Front — Key Judgements

Per ODNI IC Directive 203. Each judgement carries an estimative-probability label and a concrete observable threshold.

1

Remote

S001: frozen-CW2 + Ukraine-attrition + Iran-restraint — Pr 4.1%.

Watch: see watchlist

Pr 4%

2

Remote

S002: US-led + Saudi-Pakistan-pact-deepens + Iran-flashpoint — Pr 3.9%.

Watch: see watchlist

Pr 4%

3

Remote

S003: frozen-CW2 + Taiwan-status-quo + Korea-tension-rises — Pr 3.4%.

Watch: see watchlist

Pr 3%

4

Remote

S004: regionalised-blocs + commodity-shock + EM-FX-stress — Pr 2.9%.

Watch: see watchlist

Pr 3%

5

Remote

S005: fragmented-anarchy + climate-shock + migration-crisis — Pr 2.6%.

Watch: see watchlist

Pr 3%

02

Executive Summary

What we expect, why, and what would change our mind — Chatham-tight.

This brief is the GIPRE 50-agent slice's reading of greater middle east. It draws on 6 actor agents, 10 theme agents, five lens agents, and 100 master scenarios.

“Hormuz is open at ~62% of pre-war throughput but the option-premium has been re-priced into the curve permanently: ~\$10/bbl Saudi-Iran tension premium plus a ~\$15/bbl Hormuz-closure tail produces a Brent corridor of \$90-110/bbl that swings by +/- \$25/bbl on a single Lloyd's JWC re-listing or one IRGC speedboat incident.”

03

The Top 10 Risks

Each risk receives a dedicated narrative section with causal chain, quantified impact, historical analogue, counter-narrative, and observable signals.

1 Iran covert nuclear reconstitution + Israeli unilateral second s

Highly unlikely

Probability 5.0%

The single largest M-horizon disruption risk for the Greater Middle East is that Iran's surviving enrichment programme - centred on ~5,500 operational centrifuges (CI 2,000-9,000), the ~440 kg 60% HEU stockpile of contested whereabouts, the IAEA verification blackout since 28 February 2026, and a praetorian IRGC-Mojtaba succession - reconstitutes to a pre-strike-equivalent signature (~15,000 centrifuges or detectable cascade-hall activation) within 12-18 months, triggering an Israeli unilateral second strike whose escalation pathway cannot be controlled inside the Trump-Witkoff transactional architecture. Five interlocking dynamics make this the modal high-impact risk rather than a tail. First, the technological clock: Iranian enrichment knowledge is not destroyed by kinetic strike, and Khatam al-Anbiya plus the IRGC dispersed-procurement network can rebuild IR-2m / IR-6 cascades on a 12-18 month timeline absent intrusive verification. Iran's declared posture - sovereign-enrichment-or-no-deal - and its refusal to transfer 60% HEU to a third country (Araghchi/Khatibzadeh public position) make a JCPOA-2 architecture that resolves this within 6-12 months structurally improbable. Second, the political clock on the other side: Israel's coalition arithmetic (49 vs 61, Maariv April 2026), Smotrich-Ben-Gvir veto on any Palestinian-state framework, the Haredi enlistment crisis (5,000 of 79,000 outstanding orders), and the binding October 2026 election force Netanyahu to maximise irreversible facts (settlements, judicial appointments, strike-prerogative preservation) inside a narrow window. Third, the doctrinal lock-in: Israeli strategic culture has fused 1981 Osirak and 2007 Al-Kibar precedent with a Mearsheimer-offensive-realist 'small-state-in-anarchy' frame; any detection of a >600 kg 60% HEU stockpile, a new operating cascade hall, or weaponisation indicators (uranium-metal work, neutron-initiator signatures, integration-grade computing) is doctrinally a strike trigger. Fourth, the US underwriting: the FY26 \$4bn supplemental plus \$12bn FMS pipeline (Arrow-4, David's Sling, Iron Beam scale-up) was designed for exactly this contingency and is unconditional in current Trump-Witkoff posture. Fifth, the Iranian internal political economy: Mojtaba Khamenei's contested clerical legitimacy plus the IRGC praetorian elite-bargain creates incentives to demonstrate reconstitution capacity for domestic regime-survival messaging, even at the cost of triggering an external strike. CAUSAL CHAIN (5 nodes): (A) IAEA blackout (28 Feb 2026) eliminates the verifiable upper bound on Iranian capability; (B) IRGC praetorian succession + Mojtaba consolidation pressure incentivises visible reconstitution signalling within 90-180 days; (C) Israeli ISA/Mossad / US NRO detect a centrifuge signature crossing the 7,500 threshold or a cascade-hall activation at a hardened dispersed site; (D) Israeli operational decision under coalition pressure (likely Aug-Oct 2026 pre-election window or 2027 Q1

post-election window if Netanyahu coalition survives) launches Operation Epic Fury II via IAF F-35I, F-15IA, refuelers, and air-launched ballistic missile package, possibly with US permissive transit; (E) Iranian retaliation cycle activates Hormuz closure attempts, Hezbollah mosaic-cell projectile surge, Houthi resumption, IRGC tanker harassment - Brent breaks \$130/bbl and Suez revenue collapses to <\$300M/month. HISTORICAL ANALOGUE: The 1991 Iraq-UNSCOM trajectory is the cleanest analogue (Saddam survived defeat, retained covert programme, was destroyed in 2003 once the programme had been mostly dismantled - a precedent that ironically argues for Iranian acceleration not deferral) but the 2007 Israeli al-Kibar precedent (covert strike on a covert programme inside an actively hostile state, surgical and contained, no major escalation) is the operational template Israel will reach for. The disanalogy is that Iran has 90 million people, intact ballistic and cruise missile inventories, and a non-Sunni-Arab geographic depth that Syria 2007 did not. COUNTER-NARRATIVE: The L17 Tianxia/L20-Eurasianist read inverts this: Iran's covert reconstitution under hardening CRINK underwriting (20-yr Russia partnership, 25-yr China cooperation, SCO membership, INSTC Moscow-Bandar Abbas regular service) plus a Beijing-mediated Saudi-Iran detente that survived the war creates structural deterrence Tehran did not have in 2003-12; an Israeli second strike under this read fails (Russia/China resupply Iranian air defence, sanctions wall is already maximised so marginal cost is zero), and the under-priced equilibrium is in fact JCPOA-2 with a sovereign-enrichment carve-out (S007 at ~0.04 mass not 0.022). Mansour Naderi/Pezeshkian-Araghchi diplomatic cadence through April-May 2026 is consistent with this read. SECOND-ORDER EFFECTS: (a) Saudi \$96/bbl fiscal breakeven becomes irrelevant - Brent at \$130+ floods PIF liquidity but the SMDA's nuclear-extended-deterrence claim is teste

2

Saudi-Israel normalisation triple-lock collapse + Vision 2030 th

Highly unlikely

Probability 5.0%

The Trump-Witkoff triple-lock (US 123-agreement + Article-V-style security treaty + credible Palestinian-state track wrapped around Saudi-Israel normalisation) is the highest-utility deliverable in the M-horizon for Riyadh, Washington, and Abu Dhabi - and the most procedurally fragile. Probability of collapse before the October 2026 Israeli election is ~55% given binding constraints on three sides simultaneously: the 49 vs 61 Knesset coalition arithmetic that gives Smotrich-Ben-Gvir veto on any credible Palestinian-state framework, 99% Saudi public opposition (King Faisal Centre Q1 2026) that requires a Palestinian-state cover Riyadh's elite cannot manufacture, and a Trump-Witkoff transactionalism that bundles 123-agreement + security treaty + normalisation into a single grand bargain whose individual components face separate veto coalitions (Senate non-proliferation Republicans on the 123, Israeli coalition Right on Palestinian-state language, Saudi religious establishment on Abraham accession language). Collapse pathway is a slow grind not a single break: a 123-agreement text gets stuck in 90-day Congressional review with Markey/Van Hollen non-proliferation amendments; the security-treaty pillar gets stuck at the Article-V vs Article-IV-plus calibration that the US Senate filibuster floor cannot clear; the Israeli coalition forces a state-land designation expansion + 34 new settlements + Smotrich 82% plan extension that Riyadh treats as a precondition-violation; the Palestinian-state track gets pre-empted by an Israeli operational re-entry into Gaza Phase-II triggered by Hamas refusal-to-disarm. Each component has a ~70-80% individual completion probability but the joint completion probability under standard correlation assumptions is ~35-45%. Vision 2030 third-phase de-financing is the immediate consequence pathway: the PIF construction budget cut from \$71bn to \$30bn was modelled on a triple-lock liquidity unlock (US tech and defence FDI, Israeli-Saudi tech co-investment, AI-partnership Tier-1 status); collapse cuts the PIF AUM growth trajectory by an estimated \$80-120bn over M+12, forces NEOM to retreat further from 'The Line' Phase-1 to a 'sci-fi exhibit zone' scope, kills the Red Sea Project re-launch optionality, and forces the Saudi \$44bn 2026 deficit to widen toward \$60bn at 6%+ of GDP. CAUSAL CHAIN (6 nodes): (A) Knesset coalition (49 vs 61) blocks any Palestinian-state-framework legislation - Maariv April 2026 polling has been stable for 6 months; (B) 99% Saudi public opposition + King Salman age/health considerations force MBS to demand explicit Palestinian-state language Israel cannot deliver; (C) US 123-agreement text stalls in 90-day Senate review on enrichment/reprocessing language - Markey/Van Hollen amendments require 'gold-standard' non-proliferation Riyadh rejects; (D) Trump-Witkoff posture pivots to unilateral demand for Saudi normalisation without Palestinian-state cover (Bloomberg 2026-03-27 framing); (E) MBS declines, pivots to Beijing-channel reinforcement, \$7bn yuan-riyal swap deepens, HUMAIN compute pivots to balanced US-China architecture; (F) Vision 2030 third-phase de-financing: PIF asset-sales, NEOM 'The Line' phased re-scope, Red Sea Project paused indefinitely, Riyadh Air contract restructured, \$96/bbl fiscal breakeven becomes binding. HISTORICAL ANALOGUE: The Camp David II 2000 failure under Barak-Arafat-Clinton offers the structural template: a transactional broker (Clinton legacy push) attempting to bundle multi-veto components inside an electoral window failed when each component's veto coalition activated

simultaneously. The disanalogy is that Trump-Witkoff transactionalism is far more willing to accept partial deals than Clinton was, which may unlock a phased path (123 + security treaty in 2026, normalisation deferred to 2027 post-Israeli-election); but the joint-completion-probability arithmetic is unchanged. The 1991 Madrid Conference is a secondary analogue (multi-track regional architecture under US transactional brokerage) that produced an 8-year half-life Oslo process before collapse; phased delivery extends the deal but does not substitute for missing veto-overrides. COUNTER-NARRATIVE: The S006 best-case (Trump-Witkoff delivers full triple-lock) carries a non-trivial residual probability (~ 0.10) because the transactional incentive structure is aligned: Trump's legacy interest in Abraham Accords expansion (Azerbaijan, Kazakhstan Nov 2025 done), Netanyahu's coalition-life-extension interest in a 'Saudi peace' political prize, MBS's Vision 2030 third-phase delivery interest, and Witkoff's reputational interest in cumulative wins all create incentive alignment that a structural-realist read under-weights. If a phased 'Abraham Plus' (123 + treaty + Saudi-Israel cold-peace declaration WITHOUT explicit Palestinian-state language) is reframed as a transitional architecture with Palestinian-state-track deferred to 2027, it can clear all three veto coalitions on plausible

3

Egypt IMF EFF 7th review collapse + EGP devaluation crisis + Sis

Highly unlikely

Probability 5.0%

Egypt is the central fiscal node of the Greater Middle East and the cleanest IMF-conditioned political-economy case in the Vreeland (L02) frame; the M-horizon binding risk is the cascading collapse of the IMF EFF 7th review (due late H1 2026), which would breach the \$26-30bn external financing need against \$29.2bn 2026 external debt service, force the EGP through the 55/USD crisis threshold, trigger a rating downgrade below B-/B3, and stress the Sisi-military-business elite bargain potentially to the succession breakpoint. The risk is structural not idiosyncratic: Egypt runs the highest commitment-device dependency in the region (IMF EFF programme as binding constraint on fiscal/FX policy, Ras El Hekma \$35bn UAE deposit-into-equity as quasi-sovereign-rescue facility with \$8-10bn 2026 residual, ~\$1.3B FMF + \$2.3B IMF tranche cadence as the de-facto regime-stability rail), and three of the four flow components depend on macro variables Cairo does not control (Houthi behaviour drives Suez revenue, Israeli operational re-entry drives Gaza-II governance and Sinai displacement risk, Gulf priorities drive Ras El Hekma residual schedule). The 7th review is procedurally complex - the IMF requires divestment of military-economic enterprises Sisi's coalition will not deliver in the demanded form, the EGP corridor of 49-55/USD is wide because the underlying current-account dynamic is fragile (gas-import flip from exporter to importer; Leviathan deal \$35bn phase-1 starting H1 2026 but at variable cadence; bread-subsidy politics with 113M population and 15% inflation), and the political bandwidth for tough conditionality is reduced by Gaza-II + GERD + Sudan compound stress. CAUSAL CHAIN (5 nodes): (A) Houthi conditional 6 May 2026 ceasefire breaks (Phase-II Gaza collapse OR independent Houthi calculation OR Iranian centrifuge crisis cascade) - Suez revenue stalls below \$500M/month; (B) Ras El Hekma tranche schedule slips on Gulf-priority shift (UAE fiscal pressure if Brent below \$80, MBS-MBZ Houthi-file dispute, Qatar diversion to Gaza-reconstruction) - <\$3bn of \$8-10bn residual reaches CBE by end-Q3 2026; (C) IMF 7th review hits military-divestment-and-FX-flexibility conditionality blocks, Board defers >60 days or imposes >2 partial waivers; (D) EGP weakens past 55/USD threshold - import-inflation cascade, bread/fuel subsidy ringfence stress, rating downgrade below B- triggers eurobond covenants on \$4-6bn outstanding; (E) Sisi-military-business elite bargain stress: either accelerated military-enterprise divestment (politically costly to military) OR harder coercive apparatus (legitimacy costly) OR pre-emptive succession signalling (Mahmoud al-Sisi son-track activation, Kamel al-Wazir promotion track, or General Reda Hafez emergency-cabinet path). HISTORICAL ANALOGUE: The 1977 Egyptian bread riots under Sadat are the cleanest political-economy analogue (IMF-conditioned subsidy reform triggered urban unrest that forced reversal; the regime survived only because of US Camp David framework rescue capital), and the 2016 first-EFF EGP devaluation is the technical template (currency went from 8.88/USD to ~19/USD over six months, inflation peaked at 30%, regime survived but at the cost of accelerated military-economic-complex consolidation). The 2026-27 path differs in that the population is larger (113M vs 92M in 2016), the external debt service is higher in absolute terms (\$29.2bn vs ~\$12bn in 2016), the GCC patron capacity is more constrained (UAE OPEC exit, Saudi \$44bn deficit, Qatar capex-locked in NFE expansion), and the regional

security context is more demanding (Sinai redline, Sudan border, GERD post-completion). COUNTER-NARRATIVE: The L18 Krasner / multi-aligned-Cairo read inverts this: Egypt has a structural 'too big to fail' status (population, Suez, Israeli border, US strategic interest in regime stability) that the IMF cannot weaponise; the EFF 7th review will be delivered on schedule because Washington-Riyadh-Abu Dhabi-Doha coordination cannot afford an Egyptian fiscal cascade, and any binding-constraint stress will be quietly papered over with augmentation or accelerated Ras El Hekma front-loading. Under this read the EGP corridor stays inside 49-55, Suez recovers gradually, and the Sisi bargain is renewed in a controlled manner without succession-crisis activation. The empirical evidence for this read is the Feb 2026 5th/6th review unlock of \$2.3bn under softened conditionality, the EGP stabilisation inside 49-55 through Q1 2026, and the simultaneous Egypt-Iran normalisation (Feb 2026) + Egypt-Turkey strategic partnership (Q1 2026) signalling Egyptian multi-vector hedging capacity. SECOND-ORDER EFFECTS: (a) Sinai displacement redline activates if Gaza-II collapses concurrently - >50,000 Gazans across Rafah triggers full Egyptian Zone-C mobilisation and 1979 treaty security-annex consultations suspension; (b) Riyadh-Cairo-Ankara axis stress-tests as Saudi/Emirati support becomes conditional - axis either consol

4

Hezbollah reconstitution tempo + April 2026 Lebanon cessation co

Highly unlikely

Probability 5.0%

The April 2026 ten-day cessation-of-hostilities framework between Israel and Lebanon was negotiated under State Department auspices as the formal closure of the post-Khamenei-strike northern-front pause; it depends on a Litani-River disarmament regime (heavy weapons north of the Litani interdicted, projectile fire ceiling enforced, UNIFIL deconfliction operationalised) that Hezbollah has publicly stated it does not accept. The M-horizon binding risk is that Hezbollah's IRGC mosaic-cell reconstitution path - residual ~30% pre-war capability, smaller-cell command structure (less vulnerable to decapitation), continued IRGC technical advisor presence via Iraq-Syria PMF residuals, INSTC Moscow-Bandar Abbas continental-supply path activated Jan 2026 - rebuilds toward the >10 projectiles/week trigger threshold inside 6-12 months, forcing an Israeli pre-emption that collapses the cessation, reactivates the 80,000-120,000 northern Israeli displacement population, and stress-tests both the Netanyahu coalition (49 vs 61, October 2026 election) and the Saudi-Israel normalisation track simultaneously. The reconstitution pathway is overdetermined: Tehran's third core interest is Axis of Resistance restoration (Mojtaba succession legitimacy depends on it), the IRGC mosaic-cell doctrine was designed specifically to survive Israeli decapitation strikes (smaller cells, encrypted communications, ferret-out-resistant funding flows), the Lebanese state is structurally incapable of enforcing the Litani regime (LAF undermanned, central government weak, Hezbollah parliamentary representation intact), and Israeli detection capacity has improved post-strike but not enough to interdict every truck-load of 122mm BM-21 or Fajr-class rocket from Syria-Beqaa transit. CAUSAL CHAIN (5 nodes): (A) Hezbollah mosaic-cell reconstitution proceeds at ~5-10% pre-war capability per quarter under IRGC technical support and INSTC continental supply; (B) Projectile launch tempo across Blue Line rises from current baseline (~2/week) toward the >10/week Israeli trigger threshold over M+6 to M+12 window; (C) Israeli ISA/AMAN detect a precision-guided munition launch or strategic-rocket presence north of the Litani - the cessation's binding violation; (D) Israeli pre-emption strike (north Lebanon, Beqaa Valley, possibly Damascus-Beirut M2 supply corridor with al-Sharaa permissive transit deconfliction) escalates to multi-week air campaign with possible limited ground re-entry; (E) Iranian retaliation cascade activates Houthi resumption, IRGC tanker harassment, possible second strike at Israel via Iraqi-PMF surrogates - Brent breaks \$115/bbl, Suez stress threshold breaks, Saudi normalisation freezes. HISTORICAL ANALOGUE: The 1996 Grapes-of-Wrath cycle plus the 2006 Second Lebanon War sequence offers the clearest template: a Hezbollah projectile incident triggers an Israeli air campaign with limited objectives, escalation to 33-day kinetic phase with northern Israeli displacement, US-brokered ceasefire (UNSCR 1701 in 2006, equivalent in 2026), and a 5-15 year reconstitution cycle. The disanalogy is that 2026 starts from a much-degraded Hezbollah baseline (~30% pre-war capability vs 100% in 2006), a much-degraded Iranian patron baseline (post-strike, 5,500 centrifuges, IAEA blackout), and a much more permissive Syrian backdrop (al-Sharaa Syria with Turkish reconstruction primacy and the 18 Jan 2026 14-point SDF-Damascus framework, no Assad-IRGC supply hub). These disanalogies could mean a shorter, more contained 2026-27 cycle - or could mean a more brittle Hezbollah that breaks completely under Israeli pressure, opening a Lebanese

political-economic vacuum that the Gulf-donor reconstruction track (Saudi-Qatari-Emirati Lebanese-state rescue facility) can fill. COUNTER-NARRATIVE: The L17 Tianxia / Beijing-as-mediator counter-read suggests that the April 2026 cessation can hold under sustained US-Saudi-Qatar coordination plus a Beijing-brokered Iran-Hezbollah restraint signal; under this read the >10/week trigger is reached infrequently, individual incidents are absorbed via UNIFIL deconfliction, and Hezbollah reconstitution proceeds quietly to a deterrent baseline below Israeli pre-emption threshold. The empirical evidence is the Saudi-Iran detente Beijing-channel survival through the war + maritime hotline absorbing three IRGC-Saudi tanker incidents + Pezeshkian-Araghchi diplomatic cadence. SECOND-ORDER EFFECTS: (a) Northern Israeli displacement reactivates - 80,000-120,000 residents not yet repatriated face renewed evacuation, opposition political surge, coalition (49 vs 61) collapse risk pre-October 2026 election; (b) Saudi normalisation freezes - 99% Saudi public opposition becomes 100%, Witkoff channel deferred to 2027; (c) Lebanese state stress - LAF deployment pressure, Sunni-Shia confessional balance stress, refugee outflow to Cyprus/Europe; (d) Hezbollah political-arm survival under Israeli kinetic decapitation pressure - if Nasrallah's successor Nai

5

Hormuz closure re-imposition + Houthi Red Sea resumption + Suez

Highly unlikely

Probability 5.0%

The dual chokepoint architecture - Strait of Hormuz (currently ~62% throughput, \$90-110/bbl corridor, +/- \$25/bbl swing, no LNG alt-route at Qatar's 142 Mtpa nameplate plus 32 Mtpa NFE expansion, partial 6.5 mb/d crude bypass via Saudi East-West and UAE Habshan-Fujairah pipelines) and Bab al-Mandeb/Suez (Suez revenue corridor \$3.8-9.4 bn/yr, currently \$4.5bn run-rate vs \$9.4bn FY22/23 peak, Houthi conditional 6 May 2026 ceasefire) - is the most concentrated single-point fragility in the regional system. The M-horizon binding risk is a compound activation: Hormuz closure attempt or sustained sub-50% throughput for >30 days simultaneously with Houthi resumption above the >3 strikes/30d trigger threshold, producing a Brent break above \$130/bbl for 90 days, Suez revenue collapse to <\$300M/month, an EGP devaluation through 55/USD, and a cascading Gulf-Egypt-Levant fiscal crisis. Probability is ~19% central but the impact decile is 9 because the dual-chokepoint correlation is non-trivial (the same Iranian Hormuz-coercion decision that produces closure also activates Houthi resumption as second-front via Bab al-Mandeb) and the contagion architecture is well-mapped (Goldman Sachs and Dallas Fed both model Hormuz \$130+ for 90 days as the central tail). Drivers of compound activation: Iranian Mojtaba succession crisis (probability ~25-30%) + IRGC factionalism creates incentive for hard-line escalation signalling; Israeli second-strike on residual Natanz/Fordow (probability ~12-15%) triggers Iranian Hormuz response as the only available coercive option; Houthi independent calculation under domestic political pressure or Gaza-II collapse (probability ~30%) reactivates Red Sea attacks; Houthi cyber-attack on Aramco facilities (probability ~5-10%, but mass effect if successful, as Aramco SCADA architecture has known vulnerabilities and the 2019 Abqaiq-Khuras drone strike precedent has not been fully hardened against). CAUSAL CHAIN (5 nodes): (A) Triggering event - Israeli strike on Iran cascade hall OR Mojtaba succession crisis OR Houthi independent escalation OR Saudi-UAE Houthi-file rupture; (B) IRGC speedboat/mine/cruise-missile harassment in Hormuz escalates - Lloyd's JWC re-lists Hormuz transit at >0.7% war-risk premium, tanker daily counts drop, hull-and-cargo insurance pricing pushes operators to delay transits; (C) Throughput drops below 50% sustained 30 days - Brent breaks \$130/bbl, Goldman/Dallas Fed models activated, OPEC+ emergency response considered, US Fifth Fleet escort operations announced; (D) Houthi resumption above >3 strikes/30d in Bab al-Mandeb compounds shock - Suez revenue collapses below \$500M/month stall threshold then below \$300M/month crisis threshold, EGP weakens past 55/USD, Egyptian IMF 7th review fails; (E) Cascading fiscal stress activates - Saudi \$44bn deficit widens toward \$60-70bn at oil paradoxically high, PIF emergency liquidity draw, Vision 2030 third-phase further re-scope, Lebanon/Jordan/Pakistan/Tunisia rescue facility queues at Gulf treasuries. HISTORICAL ANALOGUE: The 1984-88 Tanker War episode in the Iran-Iraq War is the cleanest analogue - sustained Iranian harassment of Gulf shipping (Hormuz specifically), US Operation Earnest Will convoy escorts (1987), Vincennes-class incident escalation, oil price spike (Brent equivalent peaked ~\$31/bbl in 1986 dollars, ~\$80/bbl in 2026 dollars), with regional economic stress eventually pressuring Tehran into UN 598 ceasefire acceptance. The 2019 Saudi Abqaiq-Khuras drone strike (5.7 mb/d Saudi production knocked out, ~5% of global supply for

~10 days, Brent +14%) is a secondary analogue for the asymmetric-strike-on-energy-infrastructure pathway. The disanalogy with 1984-88 is that the 2026 region has no Operation Earnest Will-equivalent US deployment posture; the disanalogy with 2019 is that current Saudi Patriot/THAAD/Eastern Province defence has been hardened, but Aramco's SCADA-attack surface has not been comparably hardened against Houthi-class cyber capability. COUNTER-NARRATIVE: The L17 / L18 read inverts this: the 62% throughput equilibrium is structurally durable because (a) the Beijing-brokered Saudi-Iran detente survives the war and includes a tacit OPEC+-and-Hormuz-cohesion side-deal; (b) the maritime hotline absorbed three IRGC-Saudi tanker incidents Q4 2025-Q1 2026 without escalation; (c) Iranian Hormuz coercion is fundamentally self-defeating because PRC teapot refineries get most of the Iranian crude that transits Hormuz - closure punishes Iran's own customer and Beijing intervenes through the channels established March 2023. Under this read the central probability of >30-day sustained sub-50% closure drops to ~5-8% not 19%. The empirical evidence is three Q4-2025 tanker incidents absorbed plus the conditional Houthi ceasefire holding through May 2026 despite Iran-war stress. SECOND-ORDER EFFECTS: (a) Qatar 142 Mtpa LNG 100% Hormuz-routed has no alt-route - sustained closure removes ~12 Mtpa of monthly global LNG supply,

04

Tail Risks — Snow Leopards & Wild Cards

Less likely but high-impact scenarios. Each priced with a probability band, magnitude, early-warning indicators, an if-it-materialises cascade, and a historical parallel.

05

Master Scenario Library

100 scenarios partitioning the outcome space across stress × GP archetype × flashpoint set.

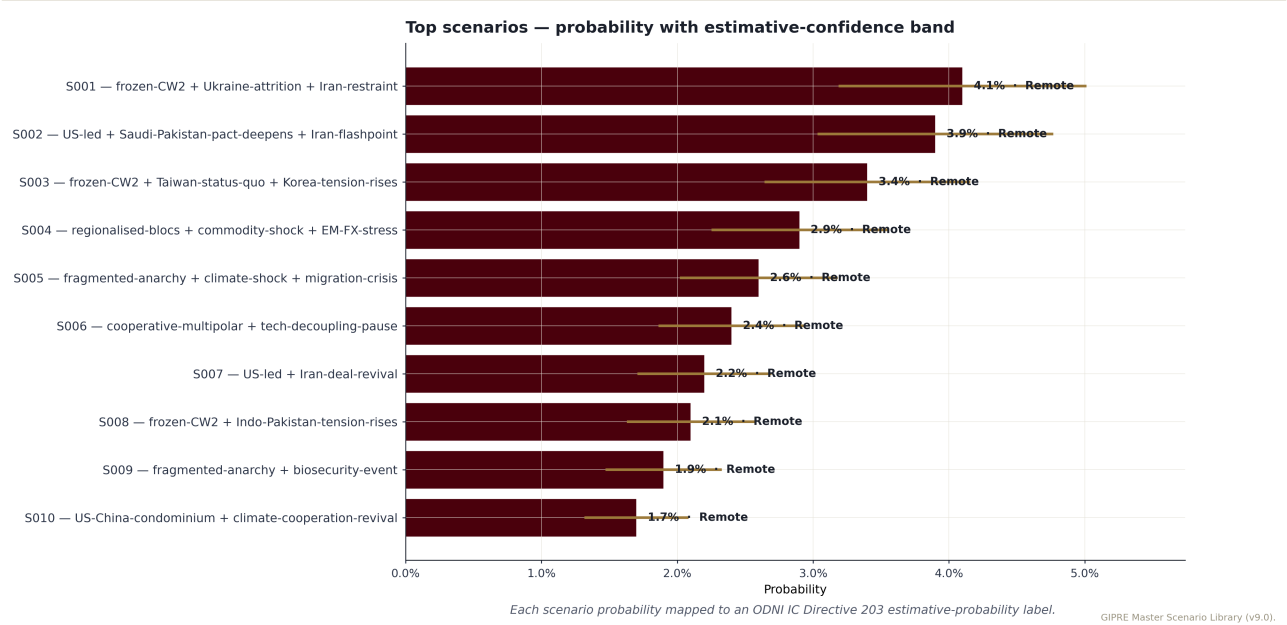


Exhibit 5.1 — Top-10 master scenarios — probability with estimative-confidence band.

Source: GIPRE master library; conformal CI per Vovk-Gammerman-Shafer 2005.

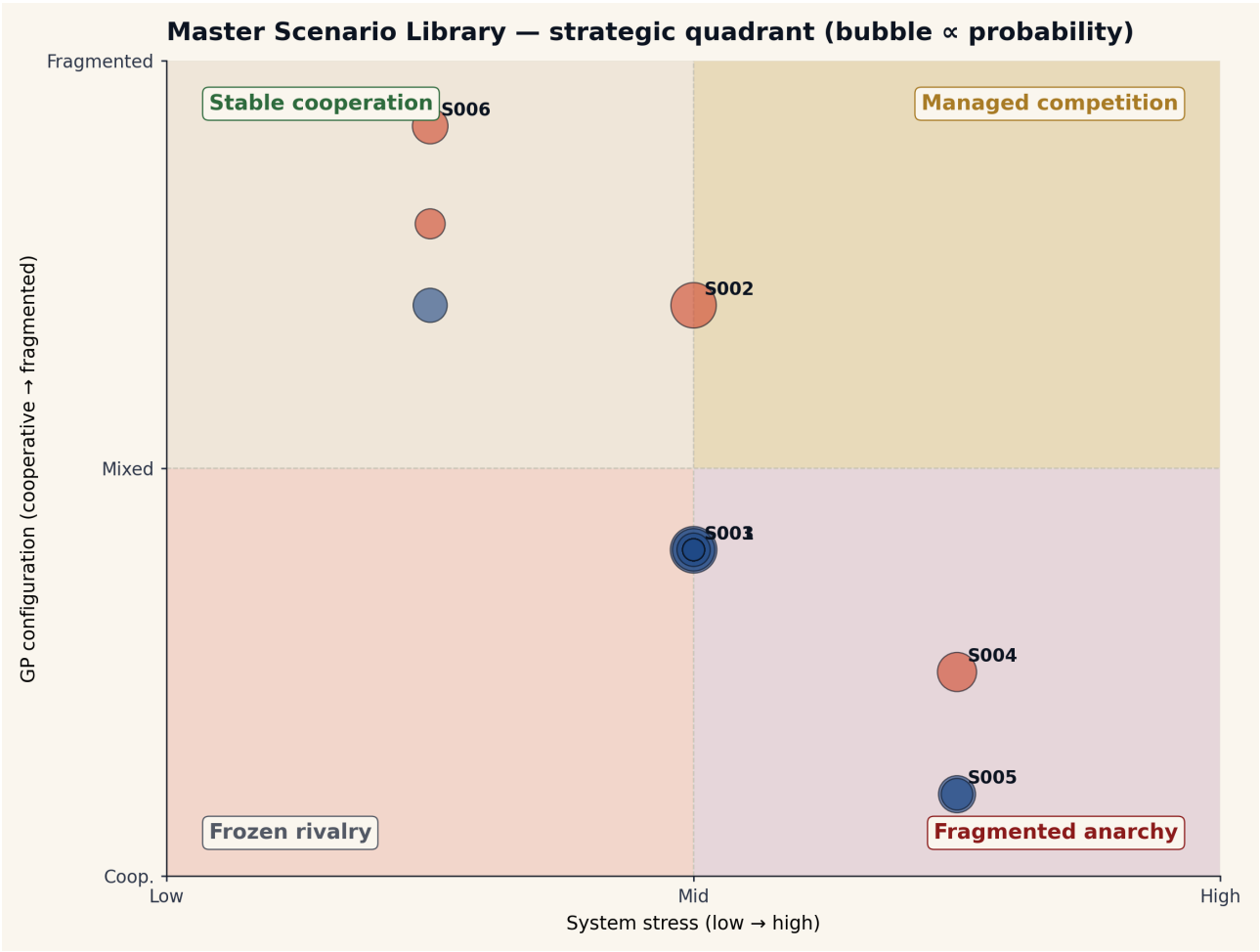


Exhibit 5.2 — Strategic 2x2 quadrant. Bubble area $\propto$ probability.

07

Actor Posture

Coalition geometry and Geostrategic Map (foreign-policy autonomy $\times$ economic sovereignty).

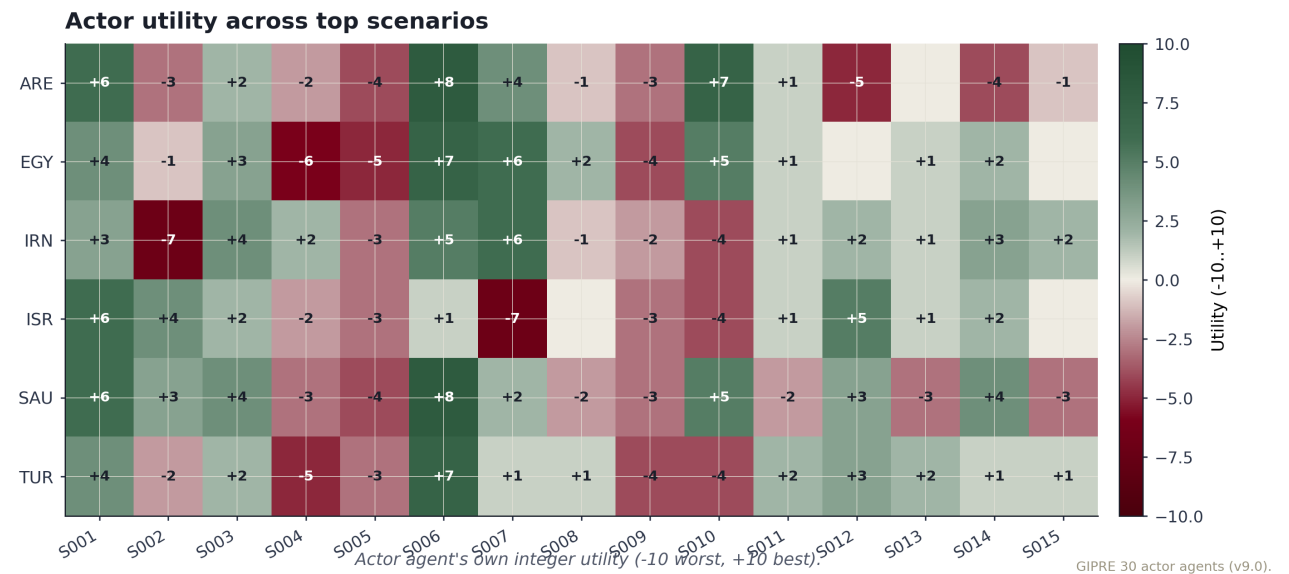


Exhibit 7.1 — Actor utility heatmap (-10 worst, +10 best) under top-15 scenarios.

Source: GIPRE 30 actor agents.

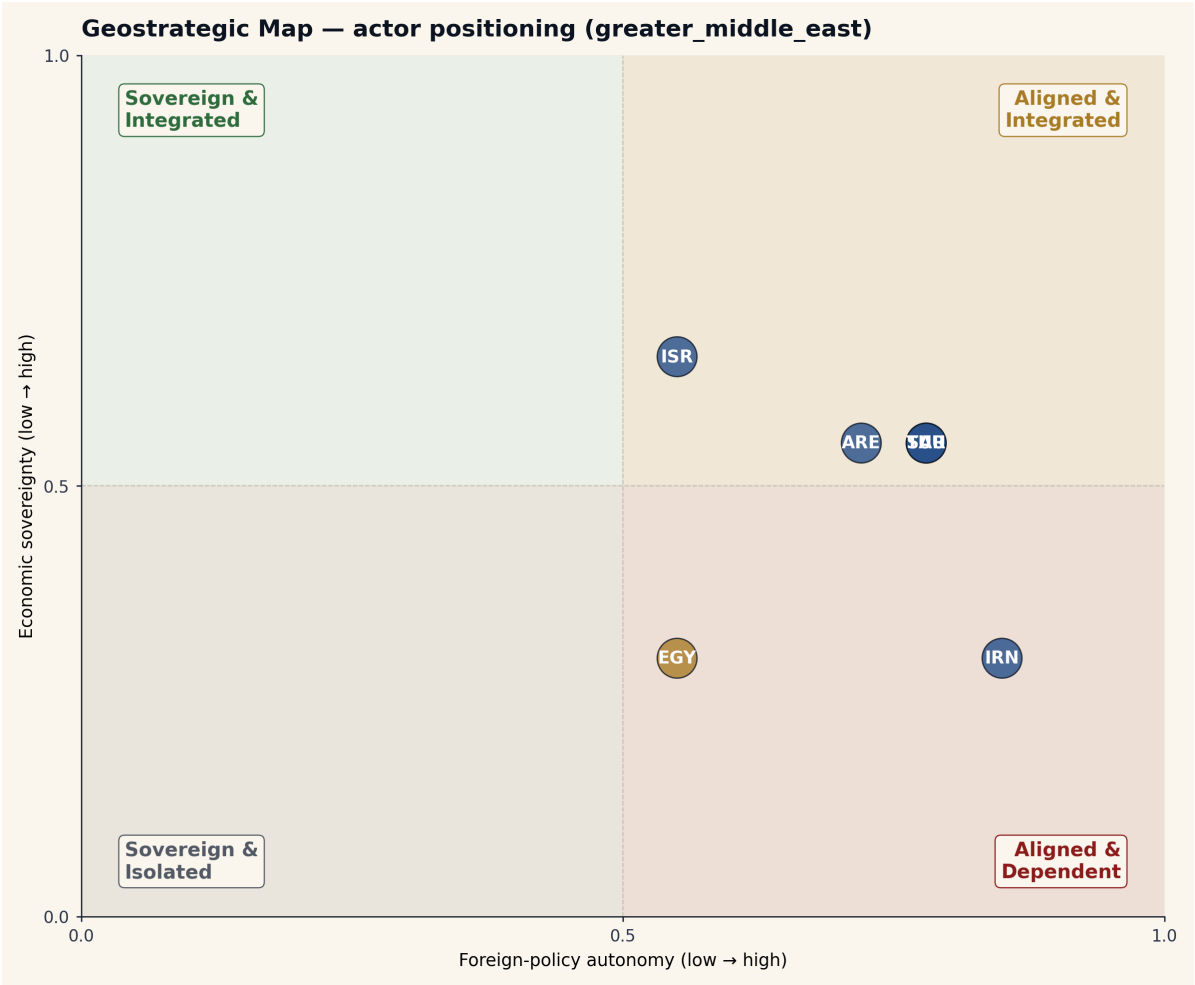


Exhibit 7.2 — Geostrategic Map. Foreign-policy autonomy × economic sovereignty.

08

Country / Actor Deep Dives

One-page profile per regional actor.

SAU

Kingdom of Saudi Arabia

Capital Riyadh
Pop 37M (2025)
GDP \$1.11T (2025)
Mil-spend 7.4% GDP

The dominant uncertainty is whether the US-Israel-Iran kinetic phase that opened in March 2026 stabilises into a durable ceasefire or recurs into a multi-month Hormuz closure; the second uncertainty is whether Washington (Trump-Witkoff) actually delivers a 123 agreement + security treaty + Israel normalisation triangle, or unilaterally demands normalisation without Palestinian-track cover. The third uncertainty is the credibility of the Pakistan SMDA's extended-deterrence claim, which has never been operationally tested and faces Indo-Pak and US-nonproliferation cross-pressures.

Core interests

1. Preserve regime survival and MBS succession continuity; protect Vision 2030's third-phase (2026-2030) recalibrated megaproject portfolio (NEOM scaled, Red Sea Project paused at 2026) under the \$44B 2026 fiscal deficit [source: Atlantic Council, Saudi Crown Prince's Power Consolidation Puts Vision 2030 Back on Track, retrieved 2026-05-10; Skift, Saudi Arabia Scraps Tourism Funding, 2026-04-16; Middle East Insider, Saudi Arabia Budget Deficit 2026, 2026-03-26]
2. Defend Saudi airspace, oil infrastructure and Red Sea/Yanbu corridor against Iranian, Houthi or asymmetric strikes during the post-Hormuz-crisis volatility (Saudi-coordinated diversion of crude to Yanbu via East-West Pipeline already activated 10 March 2026) [source: Wikipedia, 2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis, retrieved 2026-05-10]
3. Operationalise the Strategic Mutual Defence Agreement with Pakistan (signed 17 Sept 2025) as an extended-deterrence umbrella against Iran/Israel spillover, while preserving deniability on the nuclear dimension [source: Al Jazeera, Saudi Arabia signs mutual defence pact with nuclear-armed Pakistan, 2025-09-17; Arms Control Association, Pakistan Extends Nuclear Deterrence to Saudi Arabia, 2025-10]
4. Manage OPEC+ unwind of 1.65 mbd voluntary cuts (started April 2026, 206 kbd tranche) and absorb the UAE OPEC exit (effective 1 May 2026) without letting Brent crash below the ~\$70-80 fiscal-breakeven band while Brent sits near \$100/bbl due to Hormuz disruption [source: OPEC press, 1 March 2026; OilPrice.com, OPEC+ Vows to Offset 4.57M Bpd Overproduction, retrieved 2026-05-10; TradingEconomics Brent, 2026-05-08]
5. Lock-in a US-Saudi 123 civil-nuclear agreement that preserves a domestic enrichment option (Joint Declaration Nov 2025; CRS/ACA report Feb-Mar 2026) and a security-treaty pillar from Washington as the price of any Israel normalisation [source: Arms Control Association, U.S.-Saudi Deal Said to Loosen Nonproliferation Vows, 2026-03; ANS Nuclear Newswire, 2025-11-21]

Key drivers

- Hotelling-style resource-extraction calculus: with Brent ~\$100/bbl on the Hormuz shock and a ~\$70-80 fiscal breakeven, Riyadh has temporary fiscal surplus optionality to recapitalise PIF, but the unwind of voluntary cuts April 2026 and UAE OPEC exit (1 May 2026) will retest pricing power [source: OilPrice.com, OPEC+ Set to Keep Production Policy, retrieved 2026-05-10; TradingEconomics Brent, 2026-05-08]
- MBS power-consolidation phase: Vision 2030 has entered its third and final 2026-2030 phase under uncontested executive control, with megaproject scope being cut (NEOM, Red Sea) rather than ambition reset [source: Atlantic Council, retrieved 2026-05-10; Gulf International Forum, Rebalancing Ambition, retrieved 2026-05-10]

Redlines

- Iranian or IRGC-direct kinetic strike on Saudi oil/desalination infrastructure (Abqaiq-class), or on Aramco/PIF assets - triggers invocation of Article-equivalent clause of the Pakistan SMDA and request for US Article-V-style backstop
- Houthi resumption of ballistic/cruise missile fire on Riyadh, Jeddah, Yanbu, or holy-cities corridor - triggers resumption of Saudi-led air campaign and abandonment of the UN roadmap
- Israeli unilateral strike on Saudi territory or on Saudi-flagged shipping, or Israeli annexation moves in the West Bank that make Arab-League-acceptable normalisation impossible - kills any Abraham Accords accession
- US withdrawal of CENTCOM air defence (Patriot/THAAD) coverage of the Eastern Province or refusal to sign the security-treaty / 123-agreement package - triggers acceleration of Chinese and Pakistani security substitution
- Sustained Brent collapse below ~\$60/bbl for >6 months (would breach 2026 deficit assumptions and force PIF asset sales) - triggers a unilateral Saudi 1-2 mbd production cut regardless of OPEC+ consensus

- Pakistan SMDA as neo-Davutoglu-style 'strategic depth' for the kingdom: an Islamic-order extended deterrent that hedges US security retrenchment without forcing a break with Washington [source: Chatham House, Saudi Arabia and Pakistan's mutual defence pact, 2025-09; FDD, 2025-09-18] [uncited-judgement: framing as Davutoglu/Hashemi neo-Ottoman / Islamic-order lens]
- Trump-Witkoff transactionalism: normalisation, 123 agreement and security treaty are being bundled as a single Saudi grand bargain; the Witkoff Abraham-Accords expansion push (Azerbaijan, Kazakhstan signed Nov 2025) raises the cost of Saudi non-participation [source: Times of Israel, Witkoff: Countries not previously contemplated, retrieved 2026-05-10; Bloomberg, Trump Presses Saudis to Recognize Israel, 2026-03-27]

Near-term observable signals

Signal	Threshold
Brent front-month price corridor	Sustained close <\$70/bbl for >30 trading d
OPEC+ voluntary-cut unwind tranches	Any tranche >300 kbd/month (vs the April 206
Houthi missile/drone strikes on Saudi territory	>=1 confirmed strike on Saudi soil or Saudi-f
US-Saudi 123 civil-nuclear agreement progress	Formal submission of 123 text to Congress for 90
Saudi-Pakistan SMDA operational deployments	Confirmed rotation of PAF squadrons or Pakistani
PIF AI/HUMAIN deal cadence	>=1 new >\$5B compute/chip allocation from

ARE

United Arab Emirates

Capital Abu Dhabi

Pop 10M (2025)

GDP \$0.55T (2025)

Mil-spend 5.3% GDP

The dominant uncertainty is whether the May 2026 Iran-war ceasefire holds or collapses into a sustained Hormuz-closure regime — this single bifurcation swings UAE utility by roughly 12 points across scenarios. Secondary uncertainty is the durability of the US AI-chip license regime under any future US administration shift or G42 China-ties revelation, which could vaporize the Tier-1 trusted-node thesis. Tertiary uncertainty is the speed of Saudi hub-substitution: if Riyadh sustains its RHQ/aviation/port momentum through 2027, UAE intermediation rents structurally erode regardless of the Iran o

Core interests

1. Survival of UAE sovereign territory and critical infrastructure (Fujairah refineries, Jebel Ali, ADNOC upstream, Barakah nuclear) against Iranian missile/drone retaliation and Houthi spillover — the 2026 Fujairah strike (19 missiles/drones intercepted, refinery hit) is the binding constraint over horizon M [source: Al Jazeera 2026-05-04 <https://www.aljazeera.com/news/2026/5/5/us-iran-uae-trade-hormuz-attack-claims-what-we-know>]
2. Lock in Tier-1 'trusted node' status in the US AI export-control architecture (G42-Microsoft \$15.2B pipeline, Stargate UAE 1GW, US-UAE AI Campus 5GW), making the UAE non-substitutable for Saudi/Humain in compute allocation [source: Microsoft On the Issues 2025-11-03 <https://blogs.microsoft.com/on-the-issues/2025/11/03/microsoft-s-15-2-billion-usd-investment-in-the-uae/>]
3. Reopen and police the Strait of Hormuz under US security umbrella while diversifying via Habshan-Fujairah pipeline (1.5–1.8 mbpd bypass capacity) — every day of closure costs UAE crude exports and ADNOC/XRG cash flow [source: CNBC 2026-05-07 <https://www.cnbc.com/2026/05/07/iran-war-hormuz-strait-ceasefire-trump.html>]
4. Preserve XRG's ~\$151B enterprise-value trajectory and ADNOC's \$150B upstream/international plan, including OMV polyolefins champion (\$60B+) and Borouge consolidation — sovereign wealth as offensive realism instrument [source: World Oil 2025-11-24 <https://worldoil.com/news/2025/11/24/adnoc-reaffirms-150-billion-plan-to-boost-upstream-capacity-international-expansion/>]
5. Defend Dubai/Jebel Ali entrepot dominance against Saudi Jeddah (4M TEU expansion), Saudi RHQ mandate, Riyadh Air (\$30B) and NEOM — the Saudi hub-substitution play is the existential commercial threat [source: Tendify 2025-12-30 <https://tendify.net/2025/12/30/saudi-vs-uae-the-2026-economic-tug-of-war-and-its-impact-on-gcc-trade/>]

Key drivers

- Iran-war kinetic envelope: post-Feb-2026 Operation Epic Fury, the assassination of Supreme Leader Khamenei, the Hormuz blockade, and the Fujairah strike on UAE have made Iranian retaliation the dominant short-to-medium-term risk vector [source: Britannica 2026 <https://www.britannica.com/event/2026-Iran-war>]
- US AI export-control regime as a trust-tiering system: UAE has been designated a Tier-1 'trusted' node via the G42-Microsoft pipeline and Stargate UAE — this is the single most valuable strategic asset acquired in the horizon and dwarfs other diplomatic plays [source: TechCrunch 2025-11-03 <https://techcrunch.com/2025/11/03/microsofts-15-2b-uae-investment-turns-gulf-state-into-test-case-for-us-ai-diplomacy/>]
- Saudi hub-substitution strategy: Riyadh's RHQ mandate, NEOM, Jeddah port doubling, Riyadh Air, and Humain AI play are now a coordinated assault on UAE's intermediation rents — Krugman geo-economics: agglomeration advantages are contestable when the rival has comparable fiscal firepower [source: INSS 2026 <https://www.inss.org.il/publication/saudi-arabia-uae-2026/>]

Redlines

- Any further Iranian kinetic strike on Emirati territory beyond the May 2026 Fujairah barrage — second strike on Abu Dhabi, Jebel Ali, Barakah, or DXB triggers full UAE entry into kinetic coalition with US/Israel [source: CNN 2026-05-04 <https://www.cnn.com/2026/05/04/world/live-news/iran-war-hormuz-trump>]
- Houthi or IRGC mining/closure of the Strait of Hormuz for >14 days that pipeline bypass cannot offset — forces UAE to back US convoy operations and accept war-risk premia on shipping [source: NPR 2026-05-04 <https://www.npr.org/2026/05/04/nx-s1-5810508/iran-war-updates>]
- US revocation or downgrading of G42/Microsoft AI-chip export license (Group D:5 contamination finding) — destroys the sovereign-AI thesis and forces a hard China-tilt [source: Semafor 2025-11-10 <https://www.semafor.com/article/11/10/2025/microsofts-uae-ai-chip-approval-a-first-step-for-emirati-access-executive>]
- Formal Saudi-Pakistan mutual defense pact (S002 vector) explicitly extending nuclear umbrella while excluding UAE — strategic encirclement by a Sunni-nuclear bloc
- ICJ or US Treasury secondary-sanctions action against UAE entities for Sudan RSF arming — would force a costly Sudan exit and damage sovereign-wealth reputational capital [source: Foreign Policy 2025-10-16 <https://foreignpolicy.com/2025/10/16/uae-sudan-rsf-war-weapons/>]

• Sovereign-wealth as offensive instrument: ADIA, Mubadala (\$385B, +17% YoY), ADQ (\$263B rolling into L'IMAD), XRG (\$151B EV) — combined ~\$1.7T+ provides outsized capability projection consistent with small-state offensive realism [source: Bloomberg 2025 <https://www.bloomberg.com/graphics/2025-abu-dhabi-investment-funds/>]

Near-term observable signals

Signal	Threshold
Number of Iranian missile/drone events successfully intercepted vs. impacting Emirati te	>=1 impact event on Abu Dhabi/Dubai/Jebel Ali
Strait of Hormuz transit volumes (Lloyd's List / Kpler)	Sustained <50% of 2024 baseline tanker throug
BIS export-license shipments of advanced AI accelerators to G42/Microsoft UAE facility	Quarterly delivery <80% of approved 35,000-GB
Multinational RHQ relocations: net flow Dubai/Abu Dhabi vs. Riyadh	If Riyadh net additions exceed UAE by >100 RH
XRG enterprise value and IPO milestone progress (CEO appointment, asset transfer complet	EV plateau below \$160B or CEO vacancy >6 mont
Mubadala/ADIA quarterly AI and data-center deployment (\$USD)	Mubadala AI-stack deployment dropping below \$3B/

IRN

Islamic Republic of Iran

Capital Tehran

Pop 89M (2025)

GDP \$0.41T (2025)

Mil-spend 2.1% GDP

The dominant uncertainty is the survival status and physical location of Iran's 60% HEU stockpile (~440-461 kg pre-strike) after Operation Epic Fury and the post-28-Feb-2026 IAEA blackout - this single fact determines whether the Iranian deterrent posture is bluff or substance. Secondary uncertainty: whether Mojtaba Khamenei consolidates clerical-IRGC authority within 6-12 months or becomes a hollow figurehead under a praetorian junta, which inverts who actually controls escalation decisions. Tertiary: whether PRC tolerates secondary sanctions against Hengli-class refiners or quietly throttles

Core interests

1. Regime survival under Mojtaba Khamenei succession - consolidate IRGC-led security state and suppress post-war legitimacy crisis [uncited-judgement]

2. Preserve nuclear hedge: protect surviving 60% HEU stockpile (declared ~440-461 kg pre-strike, post-strike inventory contested) and centrifuge knowledge base as ultimate deterrent against regime-change strike [source: ISIS May 2025 IAEA analysis <https://isis-online.org/isis-reports/analysis-of-iaea-iran-verification-and-monitoring-report-may-2025> retrieved 2026-05-10; IAEA GOV/2026/8 <https://www.iaea.org/sites/default/files/gov2026-8.pdf> retrieved 2026-05-10]

3. Reconstitute the Axis of Resistance: re-arm Hezbollah via IRGC mosaic-cell restructure, sustain Houthi maritime coercion as escalation lever [source: Al Jazeera 2026-04-28 <https://www.aljazeera.com/features/2026/4/28/down-but-not-out-in-war-with-israel-hezbollah-shows-it-is-still-powerful> retrieved 2026-05-10]

4. Stabilize the rial and break sanctions chokehold by deepening shadow-banking pipelines with PRC teapot refineries and yuan-denominated oil trade [source: US Treasury OFAC sb0472 <https://home.treasury.gov/news/press-releases/sb0472> retrieved 2026-05-10; Al-Monitor 2026-05 <https://www.al-monitor.com/originals/2026/05/us-sanctions-irans-shadow-banking-channels-moving-oil-proceeds-china> retrieved 2026-05-10]

5. Lock-in Eurasian strategic depth: operationalize 20-year Russia treaty and 25-year China program, leverage INSTC, SCO and BRICS+ as sovereignty buffers (Krasner: institutional hypocrisy permits Iran to claim Westphalian standing while West sanctions) [source: SpecialEurasia 2026-03-01 <https://www.specialeurasia.com/2026/03/01/russia-china-iran-tech-military/> retrieved 2026-05-10]

Redlines

• Renewed US/Israeli kinetic strike on residual enrichment infrastructure (Fordow tunnels, Natanz halls, undeclared sites) after the 8 April 2026 ceasefire - triggers asymmetric retaliation against Gulf energy nodes [source: Al Jazeera 2026-04-08 <https://www.aljazeera.com/news/2026/4/8/us-iran-ceasefire-deal-what-are-the-terms-and-whats-next> retrieved 2026-05-10]

• Foreign-recognised government-in-exile (Pahlavi or MEK-aligned) receiving US/Israeli operational support, or arming of Iranian Kurdish/Baluch insurgents at scale [source: Wikipedia 2025-2026 Iranian protests https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2025%E2%80%932026_Iranian_protests retrieved 2026-05-10]

• Forced surrender of the 60% HEU stockpile to a third country or full IAEA Additional-Protocol-plus regime with US inspectors - non-negotiable per Araghchi/Khatibzadeh statements [source: Arms Control Association 2025-12 <https://www.armscontrol.org/act/2025-12/news/iaea-passes-resolution-iran> retrieved 2026-05-10]

• Chinese cut-off of crude purchases or PBoC blocking of yuan-rial settlement channels under secondary-sanctions pressure [source: Bloomberg 2026-04-24 <https://www.bloomberg.com/news/articles/2026-04-24/us-sanctions-china-refinery-iran-shadow-fleet-ahead-of-talks> retrieved 2026-05-10]

• Israeli ground incursion into Lebanon south of Litani sufficient to dismember Hezbollah's reconstituted command, or strike on Iranian soil targeting Mojtaba personally [source: Al Jazeera 2026-04-28 <https://www.aljazeera.com/features/2026/4/28/down-but-not-out-in-war-with-israel-hezbollah-shows-it-is-still-powerful> retrieved 2026-05-10]

Key drivers

- Mojtaba Khamenei succession legitimacy and IRGC-clerical balance of power post 9-March-2026 election
- Currency-inflation doom loop: rial at ~1.32M/USD, 100%+ inflation, IMF projecting -6.1% GDP 2026
- Nuclear-strike credibility under Operation Epic Fury precedent - US/Israeli kinetic option proven, IAEA verification blackout
- China-Russia underwriting of Iranian shadow trade and military reconstitution (CRINK alignment hardening)

Near-term observable signals

Signal	Threshold
USD/IRR free-market exchange rate breaching 2,000,000	2.0M IRR/USD sustained > 14 days; currently ~
IAEA verification status of declared HEU stockpile	Any formal IAEA Board resolution under Article X

Iranian crude exports to PRC teapot refineries	Drop below 1.0 mbd (vs ~1.5 mbd Jan 2026 baselin
Hormuz throughput as % of pre-war baseline	Currently ~5% of pre-war (CNN 2026-04-29); rise
Houthi anti-shipping attacks per month in Red Sea	>5 confirmed attacks/month = escalation; 0 at
Mass-protest incident count and geographic spread	>100 cities in single 7-day window with secur

ISR

State of Israel

Capital Jerusalem

Pop 10M (2025)

GDP \$0.55T (2025)

Mil-spend 5.3% GDP

Dominant uncertainty is whether Iran's nuclear program reconstitutes covertly within 12-18 months (IAEA expelled Feb 2026; ~440 kg 60% HEU residual) and whether the Trump administration sustains the strike-backstop or pivots to a transactional deal. Second-order: whether the Netanyahu coalition survives to October 2026 elections without an early-trigger event from Haredi conscription enforcement, and whether the April-2026 Lebanon cessation survives Hezbollah's stated rejection. Tail risk: a Saudi-Pakistan nuclear-umbrella extension to Iran, which would shatter Israel's regional monopoly assum

Core interests

1. Prevent Iranian nuclear reconstitution; lock in the post-Feb-2026 strike degradation (Natanz ~75%, Fordow ~30%, ~2,600kg uranium destroyed) via an open-ended Israeli/US strike-prerogative and an IAEA-equivalent verification floor [source: IAEA GOV/2026/8, <https://www.iaea.org/sites/default/files/gov2026-8.pdf>, retrieved 2026-05-10; missilestrikes.com nuclear status retrieved 2026-05-10]
2. Convert Hezbollah's post-2024-2025 degradation into a durable Litani-River disarmament regime and prevent missile-inventory reconstitution under the April 2026 cessation framework [source: State Dept 2026-04 release <https://www.state.gov/releases/office-of-the-spokesperson/2026/04/ten-day-cessation-of-hostilities-to-enable-peace-negotiations-between-israel-and-lebanon>, retrieved 2026-05-10]
3. Stabilise the Gaza Phase-II governance (Board of Peace + ISF + technocratic committee) without Hamas rearmament; preserve Israeli operational re-entry rights [source: CFR Trump Gaza plan guide, <https://www.cfr.org/articles/guide-trumps-twenty-point-gaza-peace-deal>, retrieved 2026-05-10]
4. Preserve US underwriting: FY26 ~\$4B in security assistance plus ~\$12B FMS pipeline; bind Trump administration to QME and Iran-strike backstop [source: <https://www.jpost.com/international/article-885560>, retrieved 2026-05-10; <https://www.timesofisrael.com/us-approves-6-7-billion-arms-sale-to-israel-9-billion-patriot-missile-deal-for-saudis/>]
5. Defend high-tech as growth engine (~20% GDP, 57% of H1-2025 exports, \$15.6B 2025 VC inflow) against war-risk premia and brain-drain [source: Startup Nation Central / Innovation Authority 2025 report, https://innovationisrael.org.il/en/press_release/innovation-report-2025/, retrieved 2026-05-10]

Key drivers

- Iran nuclear/missile reconstitution trajectory post Feb-2026 strikes (Mearsheimer offensive-realism logic: survival under anarchy demands strike-prerogative preservation)
- Hezbollah disarmament enforcement under the April-2026 cessation; Lebanese state weakness creates a continuous deterrence-management problem (Eurasianist read: Iran's land bridge cut but reconstitution via Iraq/Syria possible)
- Netanyahu coalition arithmetic: opposition 61 vs coalition 49 seats; Haredi-conscription crisis; pre-October 2026 election window where Smotrich/Ben-Gvir maximise irreversible facts (settlements, judicial appointments)
- Trump-administration underwriting: \$4B FY26 plus \$12B FMS pipeline; model-ally framing; but transactional risk of Saudi-deal-or-aid conditionality

Near-term observable signals

Redlines

- Iran resumes 60%+ enrichment at any covert or rebuilt site, OR expels IAEA permanently with weaponisation indicators (already expelled 2026-02-28; reconstitution detection triggers immediate strike) [source: IAEA GOV/2026/8 retrieved 2026-05-10]
- Hezbollah redeploys forces or strategic missiles north of the Litani in violation of the April-2026 cessation, OR resumes >50/wk projectile fires into northern Israel
- Hamas or successor militias re-establish armed governance in Gaza Strip and the ISF/Board-of-Peace framework collapses, removing Israeli pretext to operate
- Houthi resumption of sustained Red Sea / Eilat-axis ballistic & cruise missile strikes at pre-ceasefire tempo (Eilat port closure threshold)
- Major US policy reversal: conditioning of the \$3.8B MOU tranche on West Bank annexation rollback, or withdrawal of the Iran-strike backstop

Signal	Threshold
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Iran 60%-enriched uranium stockpile reconstitution detected (currently 440.9 kg post-str	Stockpile >600 kg of 60% HEU OR detection of
Hezbollah projectile fires across Blue Line during cessation	>10 launches/week sustained, OR any precision
Netanyahu coalition Knesset seats vs opposition bloc (Maariv poll tracker)	Coalition <55 seats for 4 consecutive weeks,
Haredi IDF enlistment compliance rate	Enlistment <5,000 of 79,000 outstanding order
US arms-pipeline disbursement rate against \$12B FMS approved	Any tranche delay >60 days OR conditional lan
Saudi-Israel back-channel signal (Trump WH readouts; Washington Institute polling)	Any official Saudi statement softening Palestini

EGY

Arab Republic of Egypt

Capital Cairo

Pop 113M (2025)

GDP \$0.39T (2025)

Mil-spend 1.1% GDP

The dominant uncertainty for Cairo at the M-horizon is whether the Gaza ceasefire holds through 2026 — collapse re-imposes the Sinai-displacement redline and re-disrupts Suez via Houthi resumption, simultaneously crashing the two principal FX-rent streams. Secondary uncertainties are (a) the durability of GCC mega-deposit flows under shifting Gulf priorities (Saudi/Emirati no-show at Sharm el-Sheikh was a warning) and (b) whether Ethiopia operates GERD cooperatively or unilaterally during the first post-completion dry season, which would test Cairo's escalation ladder. A tail uncertainty is fo

Core interests

1. Regime stability of the Sisi presidency through continued IMF/RSF disbursements and GCC liquidity (the EFF was extended to 15 Dec 2026; the 5th/6th reviews unlocked ~\$2.3B in Feb 2026 — failure of the 7th review is the single largest non-kinetic regime risk) [source: IMF PR-26064, retrieved 2026-05-10 <https://www.imf.org/en/news/articles/2026/02/26/pr-26064-egypt-imf-completes-5th-and-6th-revs-under-ext-arrange-under-eff-and-1st-rev-under-rsa>]
2. Preventing forced mass-displacement of Gazans into Sinai, which Cairo treats as an existential redline; ~40,000 troops, ~88 battalions and ~1,500 AFVs are pre-positioned in Zone C in excess of 1979 treaty caps [source: Maghrebi.org, 2025-08-20 <https://maghrebi.org/2025/08/20/egypt-deploys-40000-troops-to-gaza-border-in-north-sinai/>]
3. Restoring Suez Canal rents — H1 2026 revenues (\$449M Jan-early Feb) up 18.5% y/y but still tracking ~50% below the 2023 peak of \$10.25B; cumulative cash loss ~\$9-10B [source: Daily News Egypt, 2026-02-08 <https://www.dailynewsegypt.com/2026/02/08/suez-canal-revenues-hit-449m-in-early-2026-as-regional-stability-returns/>; AGBI, 2026-03 <https://www.agbi.com/transport/2026/03/suez-canal-revenue-down-10bn-in-regional-conflict/>]
4. Locking in GCC patronage flows — the \$35B Ras El Hekma ADQ deal (UAE) plus the ~\$30B Qatari Diar Alam El-Roum project remain the principal FX backstop; \$8-10B of Ras El Hekma tranches still due in 2026 [source: Middle East Insider, 2026-04-25 <https://themiddleeastinsider.com/2026/04/25/ras-al-hekma-uae-egypt-2026-status/>; CNN Business, 2025-10-16 <https://www.cnn.com/2025/10/16/business/egypt-north-coast-gulf-investment-spc/>]
5. Nile-water security under post-completion GERD reality — dam fully completed Feb 2026; no binding drought-year release framework; Trump offered renewed US mediation in his 16 Jan 2026 letter to Sisi [source: Horn Review, 2026-03-04 <https://hornreview.org/2026/03/04/10158/>; African Business, 2026-01 <https://african.business/2026/01/energy-resources/gerd-trump-wades-back-into-egypt-ethiopia-dam-dispute/>]

Key drivers

- Vreeland-style IMF political economy: the EFF/RSF programme acts as the binding external commitment device disciplining the Sisi regime's fiscal and FX policy; the 'too big to fail' status (113M population, Suez, Israel border) gives Cairo durable bargaining leverage with the Fund and Western capitals
- GCC patronage architecture: UAE (\$35B Ras El Hekma) and Qatar (~\$30B Alam El-Roum) deposits-into-equity are the de-facto sovereign rescue facility; this creates Gulf veto power over major economic-policy and Gaza-related strategic choices
- Neo-Ottoman re-coupling with Turkey: the Erdogan-Sisi pragmatic turn restores a Sunni-Arab/Turkish strategic axis in the Eastern Mediterranean — drones, warships and Gaza-mediation co-leadership signal a multi-pole hedging strategy

Redlines

- Any Israeli military operation or unilateral measure that pushes >50,000 Gazans across the Rafah crossing into Sinai within a 30-day window — triggers full mobilisation in Zone C and suspension of the 1979 security annex consultations
- Ethiopian unilateral GERD operation that reduces Aswan inflow below 40 BCM/year during a multi-year drought without prior notification — triggers escalation to Arab League / Security Council and consideration of kinetic 'covert pressure' options [uncited-judgement on threshold; sourcing on dam completion: Horn Review 2026-03-04]
- Collapse of the IMF EFF 7th/8th reviews (next due late H1 2026) cutting Egypt off from the residual ~\$2B in tranches and triggering credit-rating downgrade below B-/B3 — would force a disorderly EGP devaluation and emergency Gulf bailout [source: IMF PR-26064; AGBI eurobond pricing notes 2026]
- Houthi resumption of systematic Red Sea strikes (>5 vessels in any 30-day window) that pushes Suez transits back to 2024 levels — direct hit to \$5-6B/year canal rents [source: MARAD 2026-006 <https://www.maritime.dot.gov/msci/2026-006-red-sea-bab-el-mandeb-strait-gulf-aden-arabian-sea-and-somali-basin-houthi-attacks/>; Global Security Review 2026]
- RSF cross-border raid, kidnapping of Egyptian personnel, or strike on Egyptian assets in Sudan — triggers expanded Egyptian airpower campaign and possible ground deployment to secure Wadi Halfa-Aswan corridor

- Pan-African Nile politics: the post-completion GERD reality forces Egypt to choose between securitised status-quo posture (which costs African legitimacy) and CFA-based bargaining (which costs historical-rights leverage); South Sudan's CFA accession and Trump's January 2026 mediation offer reshape the chessboard

Near-term observable signals

Signal	Threshold
Suez Canal Authority monthly revenue run-rate	Sustained monthly revenue >\$800M (i.e., annua
IMF EFF 7th review board decision	Board completion with full disbursement on or be
Number of Gazans crossing Rafah into Egypt	>10,000 in any 30-day rolling window = severe
Egyptian pound EGP/USD official rate	EGP weakening past 55 to the dollar = severe imp
Ethiopian unilateral GERD reservoir-management announcement	Any Addis Ababa announcement of additional dry-s
Houthi attack incidence in Bab el-Mandeb / Red Sea	>3 strike incidents in any 30-day window afte

TUR

Republic of Türkiye

Capital Ankara

Pop 85M (2025)

GDP \$1.34T (2025)

Mil-spend 1.3% GDP

Dominant uncertainties: (1) whether the 2026 Iran war ends in regime collapse vs negotiated de-escalation — the former produces a refugee/Kurdish nightmare that overrides every other strategic gain; (2) whether CBRT orthodoxy survives politically through 2026-27 or is overridden by pre-2028-election stimulus pressure, which would crater the lira and force a Gulf/IMF-adjacent bailout; (3) whether Erdoğan attempts the constitutional-amendment / snap-election path versus a controlled succession, which conditions every domestic and external bargaining posture.

Core interests

1. Lira/inflation stabilisation and orthodox monetary policy continuation under CBRT (policy rate held at 37% Mar-2026; 5% inflation target reaffirmed; end-2026 CPI projection 13-19%) without triggering a recessionary political backlash
2. Block any consolidated independent Syrian-Kurdish (SDF/PYD) entity; embed the 18-Jan-2026 14-point SDF-Damascus integration deal as the ceiling on Kurdish autonomy and secure the 30km buffer-zone fait accompli
3. Multi-vector hedging: monetise NATO indispensability (Bosphorus, Incirlik, southern-flank IAMD against Iranian missiles overflying Turkish airspace) while keeping Russia channels open (S-400, TurkStream, Akkuyu, grain corridor)
4. Defence-industrial export breakout: Baykar (\$2.2B exports 2025) + KAAN 5th-gen fighter (Block 10 contract signed at SAHA-2026, Spain in talks May-2026, Indonesia 48 units) + TCG Anadolu drone-carrier projection
5. Neo-Ottoman strategic depth: lock in Syrian post-Assad reconstruction primacy with al-Sharaa; deepen Azerbaijan-Türkiye axis and Zangezur/Middle Corridor; OTS Fall-2026 Türkiye summit + first joint Turkic military exercises

Key drivers

- Lira / CPI / CBRT credibility cycle (orthodox stance under finance team; 37% rate; 5% target aspirational vs 13-19% realised path)
- Post-Assad Syrian settlement architecture: Türkiye-al-Sharaa partnership vs SDF integration tempo
- Iran-war (2026) regional reordering: refugee, energy, Kurdish, missile-spillover vectors

Redlines

- Formal recognition or de-facto Western military guarantee of an autonomous Kurdish polity (DAANES/AANES) outside the 18-Jan-2026 integration framework
- Greek-Cypriot or Greek-Egyptian EEZ delimitation operationalised by drilling that crosses Türkiye's claimed continental shelf / 2019 Libya MoU line
- Israeli kinetic strike on Turkish assets, advisors, or Turkish-flagged aid vessels; Israeli ground presence reaching Syrian governorates adjacent to Türkiye's buffer (Idlib, Aleppo, Homs)
- US Treasury / OFAC secondary-sanctions package on Turkish banks for Russia-trade or Iran-trade circumvention exceeding ~\$5B exposure
- Iranian state collapse producing >500k cross-border refugee inflow within 90 days, or Kurdish (PJAK/PKK) territorial control on the Iran-Türkiye frontier

- Defence-industrial export inflection: KAAN, Bayraktar, TCG Anadolu, Steel Dome — converting strategic-autonomy thesis into FX earnings

Near-term observable signals

Signal	Threshold
CBRT policy rate trajectory; abandonment of orthodox stance	Rate cut below 30% before end-2026 OR unschedule
USD/TRY exchange rate stability	USD/TRY breach >50 within 6 months OR CBRT FX
SDF-Damascus integration deal implementation	>75% of DAANES heavy weapons handed over by D
Türkiye maritime-claims bill passage	Bill tabled in TBMM with binding EEZ coordinates
KAAN export pipeline conversion	>=2 additional binding KAAN contracts (Spain,
Syrian refugee numbers under temporary protection	Stock falls below 2.5M (from 3.085M baseline) wi

09

Theme Cross-Cuts

Ten active themes — indicators, key triggers, and near-term outlook.

T01 — Over the M-horizon (6-24 months, base date 2026-05-10), US-C

Near-term outlook. Over the M-horizon (6-24 months, base date 2026-05-10), US-China systemic competition is structurally entrenched but tactically modulated by the Geneva-Korea tariff truce framework. Mearsheimer's offensive-realism prior and Allison's Thucydides-trap logic both predict that the underlying balance-of-power trajectory continues to dominate any cyclical de-escalation: PLA monthly ADIZ activity remains in the 300-500 sortie range with episodic 600+ exercise spikes; BIS Entity List growth continues at ~80-100 PRC adds/year as the 'small yard' enlarges into legacy chips, biotech and quantum; and the COINS Act sectoral expansion in 2026-27 progressively constrains US capital flows to PRC tech. The bilateral trade YoY arithmetic recovers toward zero in months 6-12 (off the depressed 2025 base) but re-decouples in months 18-24 as Section 301 statutory four-year reviews bind and any post-2027-anniversary PLA exercise risk premium reprioritises supply chains. From a Tianxia / Yan-Xuetong vantage point, Beijing's near-term strategy is to manage tactical climbdown while preserving long-game industrial-policy buffers; from a Krugman geo-economic lens, both sides are paying meaningful welfare costs to acquire bargaining positions. The single highest-impact negative-tail trigger remains a Taiwan-strait declared quarantine (TR7), low-probability but binary; the single highest-impact positive-tail trigger is an S006/S010-style leader-level communique (TR8) codifying both tariff and export-control de-escalation rails, which would flatten three of the six indicators within one quarter.

Trigger	Threshold
Average US effective tariff on Chinese imports re-escalates above 50% (sustained 30d)	effective_rate >= 50.0% for >= 30 consecutive trad
PLA ADIZ 30d sortie count exceeds 600	monthly_sorties >= 600
BIS Entity List adds >= 50 PRC entities in any single tranche	single_action_PRC_adds >= 50
US bilateral goods trade with China declines >35% YoY over a single rolling 12-month windo	YoY <= -35.0%
Presidential CFIUS divestiture order against a PRC investor on critical infrastructure or	any new EO-level forced divestiture >= 1 within ho

T02 — The composite EM debt-cascade headline (sovereign CDS 5y bp,

Near-term outlook. The composite EM debt-cascade headline (sovereign CDS 5y bp, weighted across 12 constituents) is currently in a moderate-stress regime ~480 bp, materially below the 2022-23 peak but well above pre-COVID norms; underneath this aggregate, the dispersion is large — Turkey, Ecuador, Argentina, Pakistan, Egypt, Ghana, Zambia, and Sri Lanka have all benefited from IMF programmes and have improving CDS trajectories, while Tunisia, Lebanon, and (more contingently) Nigeria and Kenya carry idiosyncratic stress. The most probable 6-24 month trajectory is sideways with a widening tail: composite CDS drifts 480-540 bp baseline but stress paths (Brent shock, Indo-Pak escalation, biosecurity event, or fresh climate-driven shock to a vulnerable importer) push the high-tail to 900+ bp by month 24. The single most binding mechanism is the Vreeland IMF-political-economy channel: 8 of 12 constituents currently depend on active Fund programmes for market access, and the calendar of programme reviews + the end of the Zambia ECF (Jan 2026) and approaching ends of others creates concentrated review-risk windows. The Eichengreen reserves-adequacy frontier is breached or close-to-breached for Tunisia (104 days, declining post-Jul-2026 Eurobond) and Lebanon (depleted), and is vulnerable in Pakistan (3.6 months) and Argentina (usable reserves only ~USD 10 bn). Diamond-Dybvig fragility is highest at the rollover-concentration cluster (EGY USD 26-30 bn, ARG > USD 20 bn, Turkey > USD 200 bn bank+sovereign), where confidence shocks can rapidly transit to runs. The defining 24-month question is whether the post-2023 EM upgrade cycle (Ghana, Zambia, Ecuador, Sri Lanka all post-restructuring; S&P took positive actions in 2026) is reversed by the geopolitical risk channel S&P flagged in March 2026 — our base case (~55% probability) is partial reversal concentrated in 1-3 names rather than a synchronised cascade.

Trigger	Threshold
Tunisia EUR 750 mn final Eurobond payment July 2026 — if reserves below 3 months imports a	reserves_months_imports < 3.0 OR FX reserves < USD
Pakistan IMF EFF programme review failure or delay — would crystallise USD-funding shortfa	any review miss; PKR depreciation > 10% in 30 days
Argentina FX-band breach with reserves drawdown — Milei monetary scheme launched Jan 2 202	BCRA gross reserves drop > USD 5 bn in single quar
Oil price spike from Middle East escalation — propagates to EGY, PAK, TUN, LKA, KEN curren	Brent > USD 100/bbl sustained > 3 months
S&P/Moody's/Fitch downgrade cycle restart — S&P warned March 2026 that Middle East war ris	3+ EM sovereign downgrades in a single quarter fro

T03 — Over the M horizon (6-24 months), the semiconductor supply c

Near-term outlook. Over the M horizon (6-24 months), the semiconductor supply chain remains the most concentrated and most politicised strategic-industrial system in the global economy: Taiwan retains ~90% of sub-5nm foundry revenue, while China's indigenisation, costly under any Krugman cluster-economics frame, is being subsidised through state capex (SMIC FY2025 \$8.1bn, Hua Hong, CXMT) and legitimated through a Tianxia/sovereignty narrative that frames BIS/NL/JP controls as illegitimate hierarchical coercion. Expect HBM3e contract prices to rise ~20% through mid-2026 before HBM4 mix-dilution softens the index in 2H26-2027; ASML's China revenue share to compress to ~20% in 2026 from 33% in 2025 as Dutch national authorisation expansion bites; and BIS to add at least one further major tranche of PRC entities tied to HBM, EDA, or advanced packaging. The Taiwan-strait status indicator will deteriorate gradually — PLA blockade-pattern normalisation inside the contiguous zone is the dominant offensive-realist signal — but kinetic conflict over the M horizon remains low-probability (modal: amber-elevated, not crisis). The dominant tail risk is the MOFCOM rare-earth regime reactivating after its November 2026 suspension expiry combined with BIS HBM-controls, producing a reciprocal critical-minerals/critical-tools shock that bifurcates the global AI hardware supply curve. Watch for tool-in timing at TSMC Arizona Fab 21 Phase 2, Samsung 2nm Texas customer wins, SMIC 5nm yield disclosure, and any return of PLA exercises to inside-12nm presence.

Trigger	Threshold
PLA blockade-pattern exercise crosses Taiwan's 12nm contiguous zone or holds inside-contig	≥1 sustained intrusion event (current baseline: ep
BIS adds HBM3e/HBM4 to controlled-items list with extraterritorial Foreign Direct Product	Single Federal Register addition citing HBM by nam
MOFCOM lifts Nov 2025 suspension of rare-earth/gallium/germanium export-control regime	Reactivation of Notice 2025/61 before Nov 10, 2026
SMIC achieves credible 5nm volume yield (>50%) for Huawei Kirin/Ascend	Independent reverse-engineering (TechInsights) of
TSMC Arizona Fab 21 Phase 2 tool-in completes ahead of plan and N3 yield parity with TWN a	Tool-in confirmed 3Q26; pilot N3 wafers >70% yield

T04 — The 6-24 month window is dominated by a Hormuz-closure risk

Near-term outlook. The 6-24 month window is dominated by a Hormuz-closure risk premium that has lifted Brent to ~\$101/bbl on 8-May-2026 (down from a \$117/bbl April peak after the 28-Feb-2026 US-Israel war on Iran and Khamenei assassination triggered Iran's Hormuz closure), with EIA STEO Apr-2026 projecting a Q2-2026 Brent peak near \$115/bbl easing to <\$90/bbl by Q4-2026 conditional on reopening - we widen the band given the ~191-vessel April 2026 traffic floor. The UAE OPEC exit effective 1-May-2026 collapses Layer-2 voluntary-cut cohesion (1.6 Mb/d of UAE spare capacity now unconstrained), implying OPEC+ compliance falls from ~88% today toward ~70% by end-2027 and an over-supplied 2027 market unless Saudi defends fiscal breakeven (~\$96/bbl IMF, up to \$108/bbl PIF-augmented) by deeper cuts that risk further defections (Mearsheimer balancing). On the minerals side, the China REE index sits at a near-two-year high (288.7 on 10-Feb-2026), dysprosium +105% Q1-2026 to \$930.70/kg, and MoFCOM's heavy-REE license suspension through 10-Nov-2026 sets up a binary trigger: reinstated controls plus the 0.1%/50% extraterritorial rule would spike samarium and dysprosium and validate the USGS OFR 2025-1047 finding that samarium disruption

alone risks \$4.5bn US GDP. Lithium-carbonate has rebounded to ~\$24,150/t on Chinese restocking and Yichun supply curtailment, but Codelco-SQM's Salar de Atacama JV (Nova Andino Lito, Dec-2025) and Indonesian RKAB nickel cuts (330->250 Mt) tilt the broader battery-metal complex toward a structural deficit in H2-2026 even as BNEF projects pack prices fall to \$105/kWh. The structural sleeper is AI data-centre demand: IEA Electricity 2026 puts global DC at 485 TWh in 2025 rising toward 950 TWh by 2030, with US +240 TWh (130%) and China +175 TWh (170%) by 2030; this underwrites a Henry Hub trajectory rising from \$2.76/MMBtu today toward \$4.50-4.80/MMBtu by month-24 as LNG-export and gas-peaker demand stack. The dominant tail risks are (i) Hormuz remaining closed past August 2026, (ii) Beijing reactivating REE licensing on 10-Nov-2026, and (iii) a second OPEC defection (KAZ or IRQ) - all three are detectable from public sources (Kpler vessel transits, MoFCOM gazette, OPEC MOMR) and should be the priority monitoring nodes.

Trigger	Threshold
Strait of Hormuz remains closed >90 days from May-2026 baseline (i.e. through August 2026)	Brent > \$130/bbl sustained 30 days; Kpler-tracked
MoFCOM reinstates heavy-REE export licensing on 10-Nov-2026 review date (after current sus	REE oxide index > 340; samarium spot > \$500/kg; li
UAE OPEC exit cascades: second member (KAZ or IRQ) follows by Q4-2026; effective Layer-2 v	OPEC+ compliance < 70%; UAE liftings > 4.0 Mb/d su
DRC tightens cobalt quotas further or cuts 2027 allocation below 90kt; CMOC over-stockpile	Cobalt spot > \$40k/t; Glencore-CMOC public dispute
AI hyperscaler capex underwriting a >900 TWh global DC trajectory by 2030 forces 50+ GW of	DC capex 2026 > \$700bn; new gas-fired build > 30 G

T05 — Over the M horizon (6-24 months from May-2026), the central

Near-term outlook. Over the M horizon (6-24 months from May-2026), the central expectation is that the global internal-displacement stock rises from 83.4m (IDMC GRID 2025) toward roughly 96m by mid-2028, a 16% increase whose mean trajectory is driven about 60% by conflict (Sudan, DRC, Myanmar, Sahel) and 40% by disaster + slow-onset climate forcing. The constituent country with the highest probability of dominating headlines remains Sudan (9.6m IDPs, 4.3m cross-border per DTM Sep-2025) - it has displaced Syria as the world's largest forced-displacement situation and risks a tipping point if Al-Fasher falls and RSF consolidates Darfur, plausibly pushing the IDP stock above 10m and outflows beyond 5m. Second-tier accelerators are Sahel food insecurity (FAO West Africa projection 52.8m IPC-3+ in the 2026 lean season, vs. 41.8m in 2025), the Philippines/Vietnam typhoon corridor (post-Kalmaegi/Fung-wong baseline of ~2m displaced in Q4-2025), and Bangladesh's monsoon flooding (>700k/yr decadal mean, with 2025 already breaching that within the first floods of the season). Reasoning from Acemoglu-Robinson, the proximate driver in nearly every case is not the climate hazard per se but the extractive-institutional inability to absorb it (Sudan's centralised rentier state, Iraq's neopatrimonial water management, Egypt's hydro-hegemonic vulnerability to GERD, Bangladesh's coastal-poor governance gaps); from a Pan-African lens this is the post-colonial state-formation failure becoming a climate-multiplier. From Krugman economic geography, expect continued labour reallocation toward Dhaka/Lagos/Cairo/Mexico-City mega-cities that simultaneously concentrate exposure to heat-island and water-stress hazards - a dis-equilibrium that resolves only via either adaptation finance scale-up or destabilising outmigration. From Hubbert depletion logic, the Tigris-Euphrates 25-50% flow loss already realised (Carnegie 2024) and Iraq's reservoir collapse to 10 bcm (lowest since 1933, Chatham House 2025) are not cyclical - they are stepwise descents on a non-renewable hydrological budget, with no upside surprise plausible in the M-window. Coupling intensity to T02 (EM-debt) and T08 (Middle-East) is highest; under polycrisis scenario S005 (Pr=2.6%) the headline 24-month fan-chart upper bound (104.9m) becomes the central case rather than a tail, while S010 climate-cooperation-revival (Pr=1.7%) is the only meaningful downward forcing identified.

Trigger	Threshold
Sudan IDP stock breaches 10 million OR cross-border refugee outflow exceeds 5 million, sig	10,000,000 IDPs OR 5,000,000 cross-border (current)
FAO Food Price Index returns above 140 for two consecutive months, breaking 2025-2026 plat	FFPI >= 140.0 (April-2026 = 130.7)

South Asia wet-bulb event exceeds 33C sustained >6 hours in populated zone (Dhaka, Karachi	Tw >= 33C, t >= 6h, population-weighted >5M expose
Iraq water reserves fall below 8 bcm (vs 10 bcm 2025; lowest-since-1933 baseline)	reservoir storage < 8 billion cubic meters
West Africa & Sahel IPC-3+ caseload exceeds 55 million in lean-season 2026 (current projec	55,000,000 acute food insecure (IPC 3+/CH 3+)

T06 — Over M-horizon (May-2026 to May-2028), the AI capability fro

Near-term outlook. Over M-horizon (May-2026 to May-2028), the AI capability frontier accelerates faster than governance: METR 50%-time-horizon doubles roughly every 4-5 months from ~14.5h (Claude Opus 4.6) toward week-scale autonomous task completion by M18-M24, and frontier training runs cross 1e27 FLOP at fan-mean before M9. The structural driver is Romer-endogenous compute investment (Stargate \$500B/10GW, Mistral 1.4GW France, HUMAIN 1.9GW KSA, Stargate-UAE 5GW, IndiaAI 8 exaflops) racing ahead of Anthropic RSP-v3.0 ASL-3/ASL-4 safeguards and FLI Index existential-safety 'D' grades. Mearsheimer power-balance logic plus Ikenberry hegemony-preservation logic both predict tightening US export controls despite Trump's Diffusion-Rule rescission and H200 relaxation: BIS Entity List adds will continue at ~10-15/quarter and a second large smuggling network (>\$500M) is more-likely-than-not before M12 given the Operation Gatekeeper baseline and persistent ~30-50% Chinese demand-elasticity for top-stack chips. MoFCOM's suspended-but-loaded extraterritorial rare-earth/FDPR retaliation is the single most consequential downside trigger - if reactivated post-suspension (Oct-2026) it depresses the FLOPS fan toward its low edge and forces Stargate site-selection toward US-aligned grids. Sovereign-AI initiative count rises monotonically toward ~25-29 by M24 as the Tianxia-tinged DeepSeek-Huawei two-loop strategy plus ARE/KSA/IND/KOR/FRA hedging structurally fragment what was a US-monopoly stack in 2024 - this is not a 'risks rising' platitude but a measurable phase change visible in the sovereign_ai_initiative_count series and the METR cross-lab dispersion. Detection: monitor (a) quarterly Epoch frontier-FLOPS releases, (b) METR Time Horizon 1.1 monthly updates, (c) BIS Federal Register rule-rounds, (d) DOJ-SDTX-style smuggling unsealing dockets, (e) MoFCOM announcement page for the Oct-2026 suspension expiry.

Trigger	Threshold
METR 50%-time horizon crosses 24 hours (1440 min) for any frontier model	1440 minutes on RE-Bench/HCAST/SWAA composite, 50%
Frontier training run crosses 1e27 FLOP threshold publicly verified	1e27 FLOP single training run, Epoch-confirmed
Second major AI chip smuggling network seized with >\$500M value	>\$500M USD seizure value, single network
China retaliatory MoFCOM extraterritorial rare-earth/AI control activates extraterritorial	MoFCOM extraterritorial 50%-rule on rare earth/AI-
Sovereign-AI initiative count crosses 20 distinct >\$1B programs	20 sovereign programs

T07 — Over the M horizon (6-24 months), the new-SDN-listings-30d h

Near-term outlook. Over the M horizon (6-24 months), the new-SDN-listings-30d headline rises modestly from ~165/month to ~205/month under the central path, driven less by Russia (where the architecture is mature and additions are slowing) and more by the Iran cluster (~1,000 Iran-related persons/vessels designated since Feb 2025, ~83/month run-rate) plus China-linked secondary actions (Hengli refinery, ~40 Iran shadow-fleet firms, May 2026). The chokepoint logic of Farrell-Newman remains intact - 48% of global SWIFT payments and the overwhelming share of correspondent USD clearing still pass through U.S. jurisdiction - but the panopticon side is eroding as CIPS rises from \$24.5T (2024) to \$26.4T (2025) annualized throughput and Beijing readies a mixed-settlement structure for 2026. The binding constraint is enforcement capacity, not legal authority: 111 designated shadow tankers were still loading Russian crude in early 2026, and 68% of Russian crude moved on G7+ sanctioned tankers. Expect three regime-shift triggers to watch: (i) any designation of a top-10 Chinese commercial bank (would test the secondary-sanctions threat and is the cleanest stress-test of Eichengreen network-incumbency), (ii) a sustained breach of 5% RMB share in SWIFT global payments combined with > 1.5T RMB CIPS daily peaks, and (iii) BIS Entity List flow > 500 adds in a 12-month window (the Lutnick escalation pledge). Downside paths (S006, S007, S010) cluster around Iran-deal revival or US-China condominium and would compress the indicator by 30-50% within two quarters. Country exposure peaks for IRN (0.99), RUS (0.98), PRK

(0.95), USA (0.92, as the system operator absorbing reputational and de-dollarization risk), and CHN (0.78); third-country hubs TUR (0.74) and ARE (0.71) face the steepest marginal enforcement risk if the Treasury moves decisively beyond designating individual evader networks toward systemic action against host financial systems.

Trigger	Threshold
Single month of new_sdn_listings_30d > 300 (Iran+Russia clusters firing simultaneously)	300
Designation of a top-10 Chinese commercial bank for facilitating Russia/Iran transactions	1
Shadow-fleet-designated tankers share of Russian seaborne crude exports > 60% (compliance-	0.6
RMB share of SWIFT global payments crosses 5% AND CIPS daily peak > 1.5T RMB (system-shift	0.05
OFAC civil penalties annualized > \$500M (enforcement-tempo regime shift)	500000000

T08 — The M-horizon (May 2026 - May 2028) baseline for Middle East

Near-term outlook. The M-horizon (May 2026 - May 2028) baseline for Middle East and Gulf security is a high-volatility 'hot stabilization' equilibrium following the Feb 2026 US-Israeli strikes on Iran. Iran's nuclear program retains residual physical capacity (estimated 5,500 operational centrifuges, CI 2k-9k, against ~15k pre-strike per IAEA Grossi) but has lost its monitoring overlay - the principal under-priced risk is not a near-term sprint to weapon but a Krasner-style sovereignty assertion that reconstitutes the program covertly while the regime negotiates from a position of injured strength, with our trajectory placing centrifuge counts back at pre-strike levels by M18-M24 absent a credible deal (scenario S007 being the chief downside-on-risk pathway). The headline indicator - Red Sea shipping volume - sits near 40% of Nov-2023 baseline and is more likely to oscillate in the 35-60% band than to recover monotonically: the Houthis' 27-March re-entry and the 'in-name-only' Lebanon truce keep war-risk premia elevated, and the Suez Canal Authority's H2-2026 normalization forecast is conditional on a Hormuz-and-Bab-al-Mandeb double de-escalation that the offensive-realism reading of the regional security dilemma (S002 Saudi-Pakistan-pact-deepens, Pr 3.9%) actively undermines. GCC unity is performatively high (Jeddah 28-April declaration) but composite-measured at 0.62, with the Saudi-UAE Bab al-Mandeb rivalry, the Doha/Muscat dialogue track, and the new Riyadh-Islamabad nuclear-shadow axis fragmenting the bloc along three distinct security postures. Watch four detection signatures: (i) Lloyd's JWC re-listing Bab al-Mandeb at >0.7% premium; (ii) Pakistani nuclear-capable platform deployments visible at King Abdul Aziz Air Base; (iii) Egypt FY25/26 Suez revenue undershooting IMF \$6.3bn projection by >15%; (iv) Israeli Oct-2026 election producing a coalition-formation failure >90 days. The dominant cross-theme transmission is T04 (oil, coupling 0.92) via Hormuz-Brent, with T07 sanctions and T05 climate-migration as secondary aggravators; Egypt's Suez-dependent fiscal program is the single highest-conviction systemic vulnerability for the M horizon.

Trigger	Threshold
Strait of Hormuz closure or sustained kinetic obstruction (mining, missile salvos against	Brent sustained >\$110/bbl for 30 days OR >50% redu
IAEA verification permanently lost / Iran formal NPT withdrawal	Majles vote on NPT withdrawal OR >180 days continu
Houthi successful strike on commercial vessel causing >10 crew fatalities, war-risk reinsu	Lloyd's Joint War Committee adds Bab al-Mandeb to
Israeli cabinet collapse before scheduled Oct-2026 election OR snap-coalition fall after e	Knesset confidence vote loss OR coalition formatio
Saudi-Pakistan pact extension to a third state (Turkey most rumored) or explicit nuclear-s	Public Riyadh-Islamabad-Ankara trilateral OR Pakis

T09 — Baseline (M-horizon, May 2026 - May 2028): the Taiwan Strait

Near-term outlook. Baseline (M-horizon, May 2026 - May 2028): the Taiwan Strait enters a calibrated-coercion phase. PLA ADIZ tempo has dropped ~46.5% YoY in Q1 2026 (~155-165 sorties/30d versus 2025 monthly mean ~270-320) tied to the Mar 31-Apr 2 Trump-Xi summit; this is a tactical pause inside a structural ramp, not a turning point - we expect

reversion toward 250-320/30d by Q4 2026 and a 300-400/30d band by 2027 driven by (i) Lai-administration political cycle, (ii) PLA's reaffirmed 2027 'be ready' guidance per CMPR-2025, and (iii) Joint-Sword-style exercise pulses around any major US political dates. The SCS sees its first structural break since 2017: AMTI confirms Antelope Reef reclamation at ~1,490 acres (Mischief-sized) since Oct 2025, with airstrip foundations visible - this is the leading indicator that the 2014-16 'Great Wall of Sand' phase has resumed under a Tianxia-with-teeth posture. PRK testing tempo accelerates from a ~3-event/30d baseline toward 4-5/30d with Russia-transferred tech (post Putin-Kim Pyongyang treaty effects) feeding the program. Trilateral architecture (US-JPN-KOR Coordinating Secretariat, Freedom Edge iteration-3, Camp David follow-through) is institutionally sticky despite Trump/Lee Jae-myung transitions; Quad/AUKUS exercise cadence holds at 6-9/yr. Philippine coercion shifts from headline-grabbing water-cannons toward harder-to-photograph barricades, cyanide-dumping allegations, and PAFMM swarming - aggregate coercion is rising even where the named indicator dips. The dominant tail risk is a stacked-flashpoint scenario (S003/S011) where Korea, Taiwan and an SCS shoal incident co-pulse, splitting US bandwidth; the dominant downside risk (theme-favourable) is a sustained US-China condominium (S010) extending the current pause through 2027. Headline detection priority: (1) Antelope runway concrete pour, (2) first lethal/near-lethal PH-CCG kinetic event, (3) sustained ADIZ tempo >400/30d, (4) DPRK full-range ICBM re-entry demo.

Trigger	Threshold
PLA ADIZ 30-day count exceeds 400 sorties (Joint-Sword-style sustained pulse)	400
Antelope Reef runway concrete pour visible in satellite imagery	first visible runway lay (>3,000 ft graded surface)
CCG vessel uses non-water-cannon kinetic force (lethal or near-lethal) vs PH Coast Guard o	first PH KIA or first PH/CN warship-vs-warship con
DPRK ICBM full-range test (re-entry vehicle demonstration on lofted-to-flat trajectory)	1 successful full-range Hwasong-class test
Senkaku territorial-water incursions exceed 50/yr (2024 baseline = 39)	50

T10 — Over horizon M (May 2026 - May 2028) the polycrisis index tr

Near-term outlook. Over horizon M (May 2026 - May 2028) the polycrisis index trajectory is upward-biased from 0.71 to a central 0.79 (CI 0.63-0.90) driven by three locked-in mechanisms and one wildcard. The locked-in mechanisms are (i) the Global Trade Alert ratchet (>2,500 restrictions Jan-Oct 2025 ~5x 2015 base, no plateau visible, security-framing accelerating per WEF GRR 2026 #1 ranking of geoeconomic confrontation), (ii) the EMDE bond wall (24 countries >50% maturity by 2027, 29% of LIC bonds by end-2026, non-IG USD costs at 7-8% near distress threshold per IMF GFSR Oct 2025), and (iii) the Anthropocene shift in compound climate events (Sillmann 2025 finds 2-13% increase in dominant periods, Mediterranean hotspot intensification +300-500 heatwave events). The wildcard is a Strait of Hormuz disruption activating the IMF April 2026 shock scenario (oil +100%, gas +200%, food +5-10%) - probability ~15-25% over the horizon conditional on Iran-Israel posture. Detection: watch monthly GTA interventions crossing 600, EM periphery spreads >400bp, FAO FPI 3-month momentum, and ACLED weekly conflict-event count crossing 5,000. Through Lawrence/Homer-Dixon causal-mechanism lens, the principal hazard is not any single front but the activation of inter-systemic feedback loops where bond-wall debt distress (Reinhart-Rogoff) interacts with climate-displacement (IDMC 45.8M disaster-displaced last year) and food-energy correlation (FAO +2.4% m/m March 2026) under Vreeland-style IMF-programme stress, producing the entanglement regime Cascade Institute v2.5 maps to its negative attractor basin. Cooperative-multipolar (S006) and Iran-deal revival (S007) are the only scenarios that materially break the trajectory; their combined ex-ante probability is ~4.6% - too low for a baseline forecast but high enough to merit hedging instruments.

Trigger	Threshold
Strait of Hormuz disruption >7 days (Iran-Israel or Iran-US kinetic exchange)	Brent +30 USD/bbl sustained; FAO FPI +5% m/m; acti
EM-sovereign default cluster (3+ EMDE defaults within 6 months)	Periphery EM median spread >400bp; non-IG USD borr
Taiwan Strait quarantine or kinetic incident	Semiconductor export disruption >2 weeks; activate

Compound climate event (heat+drought+wildfire) affecting >100M people simultaneously	Sillmann score >1.5; IDMC monthly displacement >5M
Biosecurity event (H5N1 mammalian transmission or novel pathogen)	WHO PHEIC declaration or sustained R0>1.5 with cas

10

Lens Panel

Five schools of thought; theoretical pluralism made explicit.

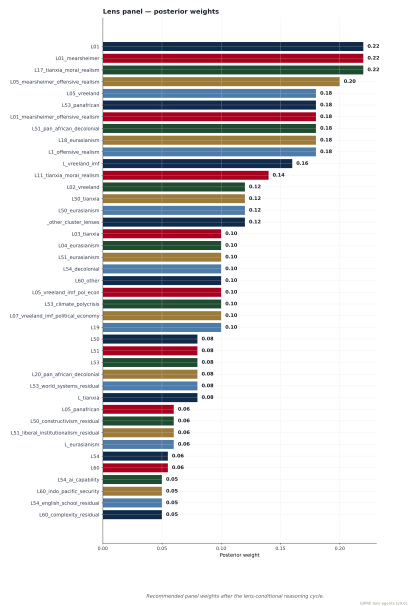


Exhibit 10.1 — Recommended posterior weights across the panel.

- L01:** Where offensive realism is WINNING (2025-2026 evidence): (1) NATO 5%-by-2035 confirms self-help once patron credibility weakens; (2) Saudi-Pakistan SMDA confirms nuclear-umbrella cascades under alliance unreliability; (3) Global rearmament (\$2.9T, +14% Europe, +8.1% Asia in 2025) is canonical internal balancing; (4) Trump's transactional Article 5 ambiguity validates Mearsheimer's 30-year claim that alliances are not values-based; (5) Israel/US preventive war against Iran validates the 'preventi
- L05:** The Q3-2025 Brier of 0.18 (Doc 4 \$9.4) is empirically HIGH for this lens, and I acknowledge it candidly. Three reasons. (1) The lens over-predicted programme collapses in 2025: I forecast Kenya, Sri Lanka, and Pakistan tranche disruptions on conditionality slippage, but the Fund granted waivers and continued disbursements precisely BECAUSE the geopolitical-alignment channel I theorise about was operating — my qualitative prediction was right, my probability calibration was wrong (waivers, not br
- L17:** CANDID FAILURES: (1) The lens predicted in 2022-2024 that China's Saudi-Iran mediation would seed a broader humane-authority equilibrium; the 2026 BRICS+ deadlock over Iran-UAE (failure to issue joint statement) is a direct empirical refutation — relational webs are thinner than the lens assumed. (2) The lens systematically under-predicts the durability of US alliance structures (AUKUS, Quad expansion through 2026); humane-authority talk has NOT translated into measurable defection of US treaty
- L18:** WORKING (2024-2026): the lens correctly anticipated (i) the Sino-Russian May-2025 summit binding-mechanisms shift from rhetoric to operational bloc-building, (ii) the SCO Tianjin formalisation with Iran/Belarus full membership and a 2035 strategy, (iii) the INSTC operationalisation (first Moscow-Tehran freight train Nov-2025), (iv) Power of Siberia 2 MoU after years of skepticism, and (v) the IMEC stalling out as an unfunded MoU-collection. The Mackinder-Spykman map is recognisably the 2026 map.
- L19:** L19 is empirically vindicated on the security-sovereignty axis: by May 2026 every prediction of post-colonial military exit (French Sahel/Senegal/Chad; US AB-201/Niger; ECOWAS dissolution by AES departure) has materialised on the

timeline Mazrui (1986) sketched. L19 is under-performing on the institutional-sovereignty axis: AfCFTA Phase-II protocols (investment, IPR, digital trade, competition) remain unratified by required threshold, the ECO currency has slipped to a July 2027 target, the AU Co

11

Decision Implications

Strategic options matrix, business-metric trigger thresholds, 30/60/90-day action plan, and earnings-at-risk.

12

Persona Implications

Quantified specifics for each client archetype.

14

Watchlist

Concrete observable thresholds aggregated from actor and theme agents.

#	Actor	Signal	Threshold	Source
1	ARE	Number of Iranian missile/drone events successfully intercepted vs. impacting Em	>=1 impact event on Abu Dhabi/Dubai/Jebe	www.aljazeera.com
2	ARE	Strait of Hormuz transit volumes (Lloyd's List / Kpler)	Sustained <50% of 2024 baseline tanker t	www.npr.org
3	ARE	BIS export-license shipments of advanced AI accelerators to G42/Microsoft UAE fa	Quarterly delivery <80% of approved 35,0	blogs.microsoft.com
4	EGY	Suez Canal Authority monthly revenue run-rate	Sustained monthly revenue >\$800M (i.e.,	Daily News Egypt 2026-02-08 www.da
5	EGY	IMF EFF 7th review board decision	Board completion with full disbursement	IMF PR-26064 2026-02-26 www.imf.or
6	EGY	Number of Gazans crossing Rafah into Egypt	>10,000 in any 30-day rolling window = s	Maghrebi.org 2025-08-20 maghrebi.o
7	IRN	USD/IRR free-market exchange rate breaching 2,000,000	2.0M IRR/USD sustained > 14 days; curren	Iran International www.iranintl.co
8	IRN	IAEA verification status of declared HEU stockpile	Any formal IAEA Board resolution under A	IAEA GOV
9	IRN	Iranian crude exports to PRC teapot refineries	Drop below 1.0 mbd (vs ~1.5 mbd Jan 2026	Vision Times 2026-05-01 www.vision
10	ISR	Iran 60%-enriched uranium stockpile reconstitution detected (currently 440.9 kg	Stockpile >600 kg of 60% HEU OR detectio	missilestrikes.com
11	ISR	Hezbollah projectile fires across Blue Line during cessation	>10 launches/week sustained, OR any prec	www.aljazeera.com
12	ISR	Netanyahu coalition Knesset seats vs opposition bloc (Maariv poll tracker)	Coalition <55 seats for 4 consecutive we	www.jpost.com

13	SAU	Brent front-month price corridor	Sustained close <\$70/bbl for >30 trading	TradingEconomics Brent, tradingeco
14	SAU	OPEC+ voluntary-cut unwind tranches	Any tranche >300 kbd/month (vs the April	OPEC.org press release 1 March 202
15	SAU	Houthi missile/drone strikes on Saudi territory	>=1 confirmed strike on Saudi soil or Sa	Wikipedia, 2025 US-Houthi ceasefire
16	TUR	CBRT policy rate trajectory; abandonment of orthodox stance	Rate cut below 30% before end-2026 OR un	www.tcmb.gov.tr
17	TUR	USD/TRY exchange rate stability	USD/TRY breach >50 within 6 months OR CB	www.paturkey.com
18	TUR	SDF-Damascus integration deal implementation	>75% of DAANES heavy weapons handed over	en.wikipedia.org

15

Geographic Reference

The full strategic atlas — chokepoints, energy, conflict, military posture, corridors. Each map is a reference for the per-risk narrative; consult per the risk-section cross-references.

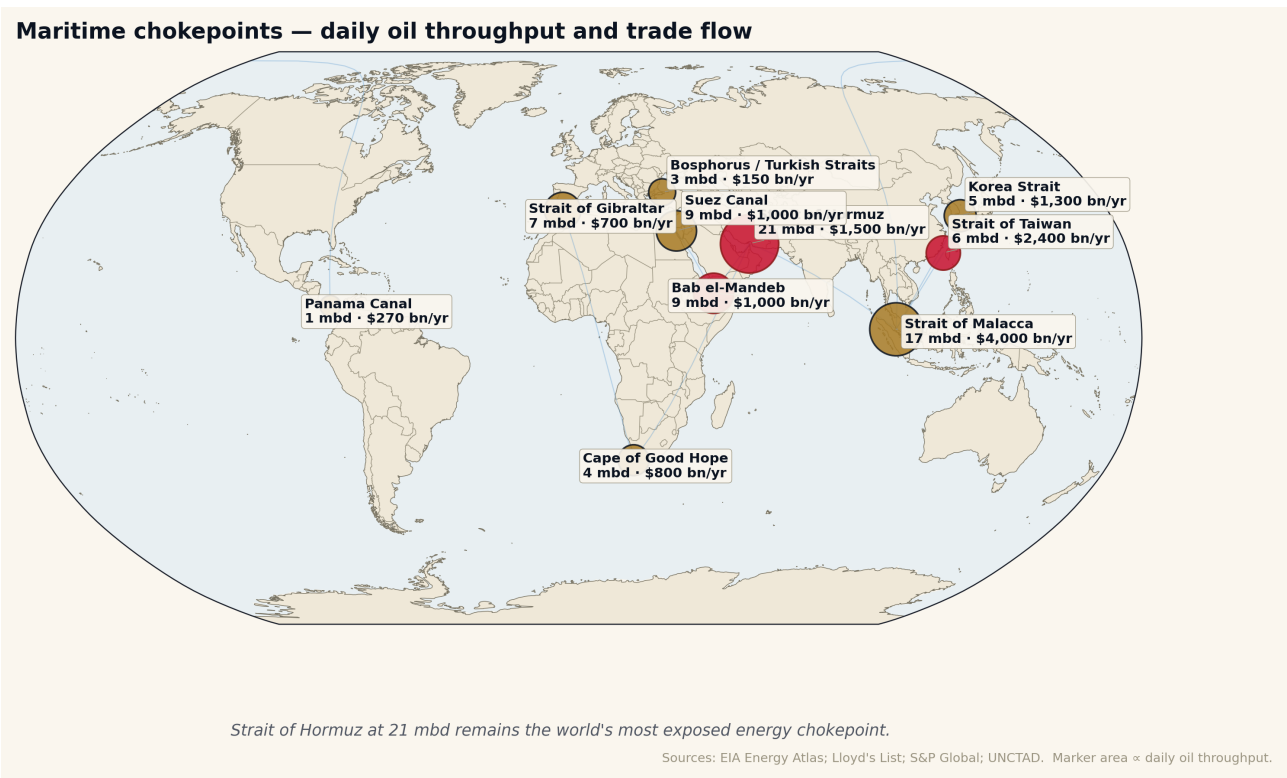


Exhibit 15.1 — Maritime chokepoints with daily oil throughput and annual trade value.

Sources: EIA Energy Atlas; Lloyd's List; S&P Global Commodity Insights.

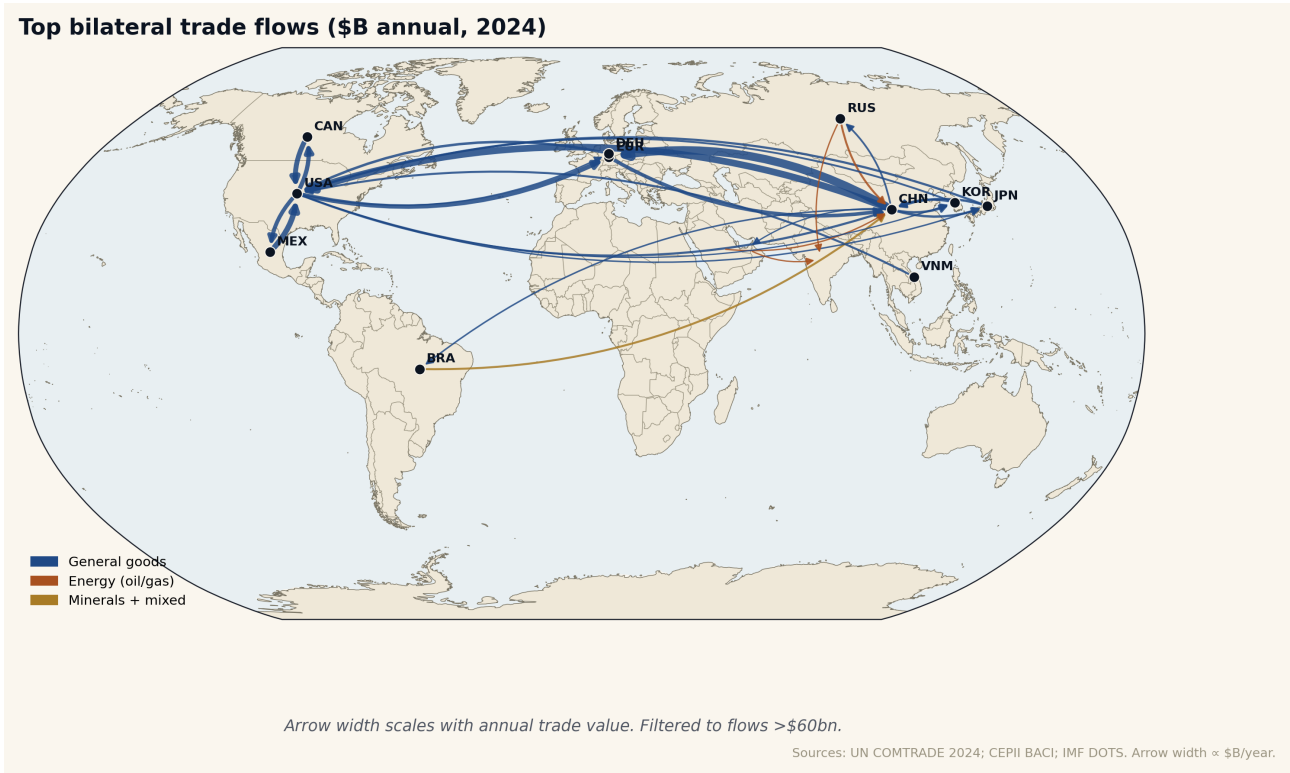


Exhibit 15.2 — Top bilateral trade flows (>\$60bn annual). Arrow width $\propto$ value.

Sources: UN COMTRADE 2024; CEPII BACI.

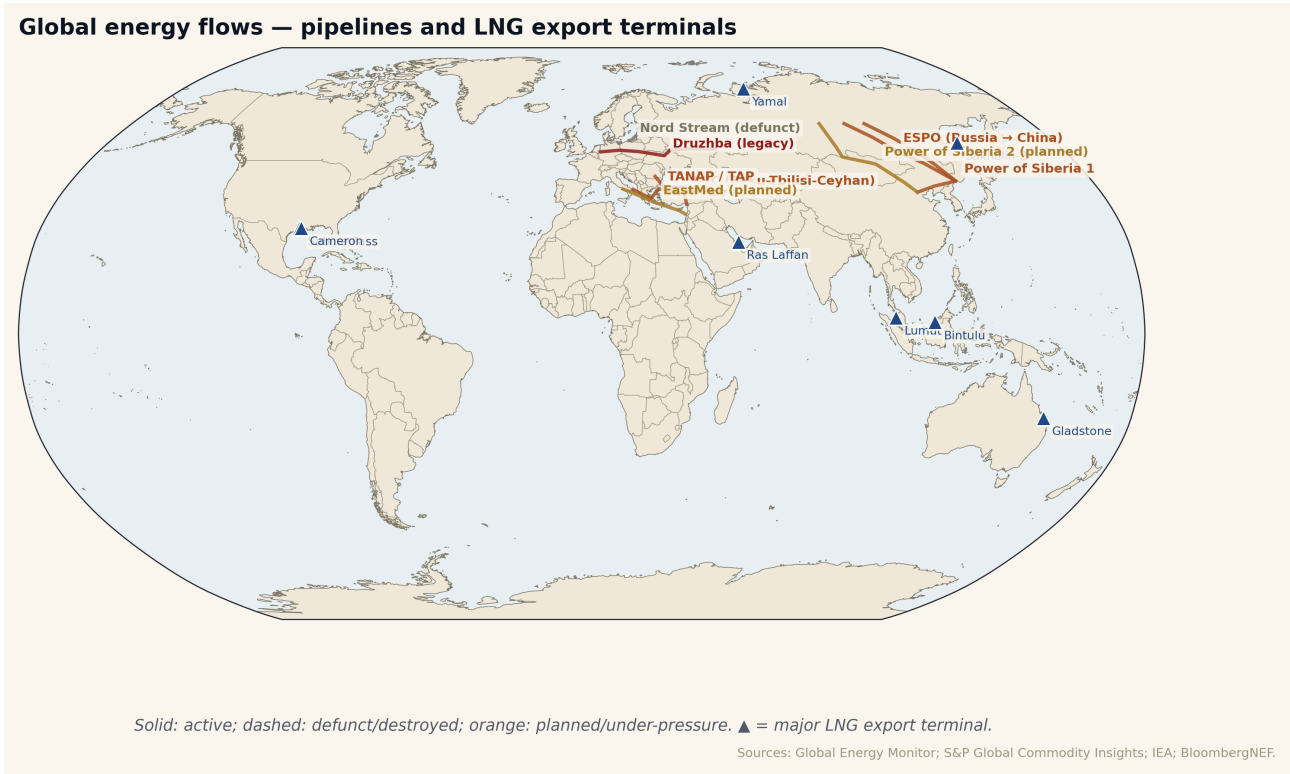


Exhibit 15.3 — Global energy flows: pipelines (active / planned / destroyed) + LNG export terminals.

Sources: Global Energy Monitor; S&P Global Commodity Insights; IEA.

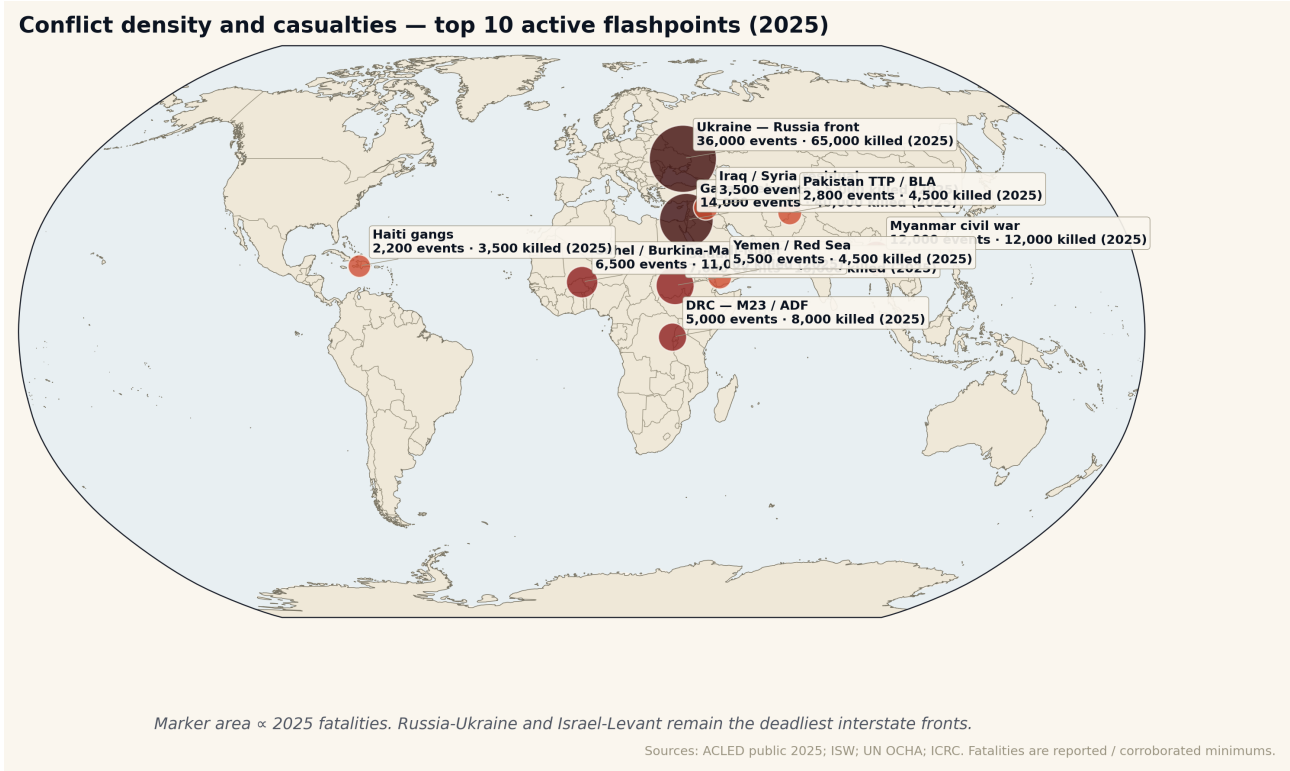


Exhibit 15.4 — Top-10 active flashpoints with 2025 events and fatalities.

Sources: ACLED public 2025; ISW; UN OCHA.

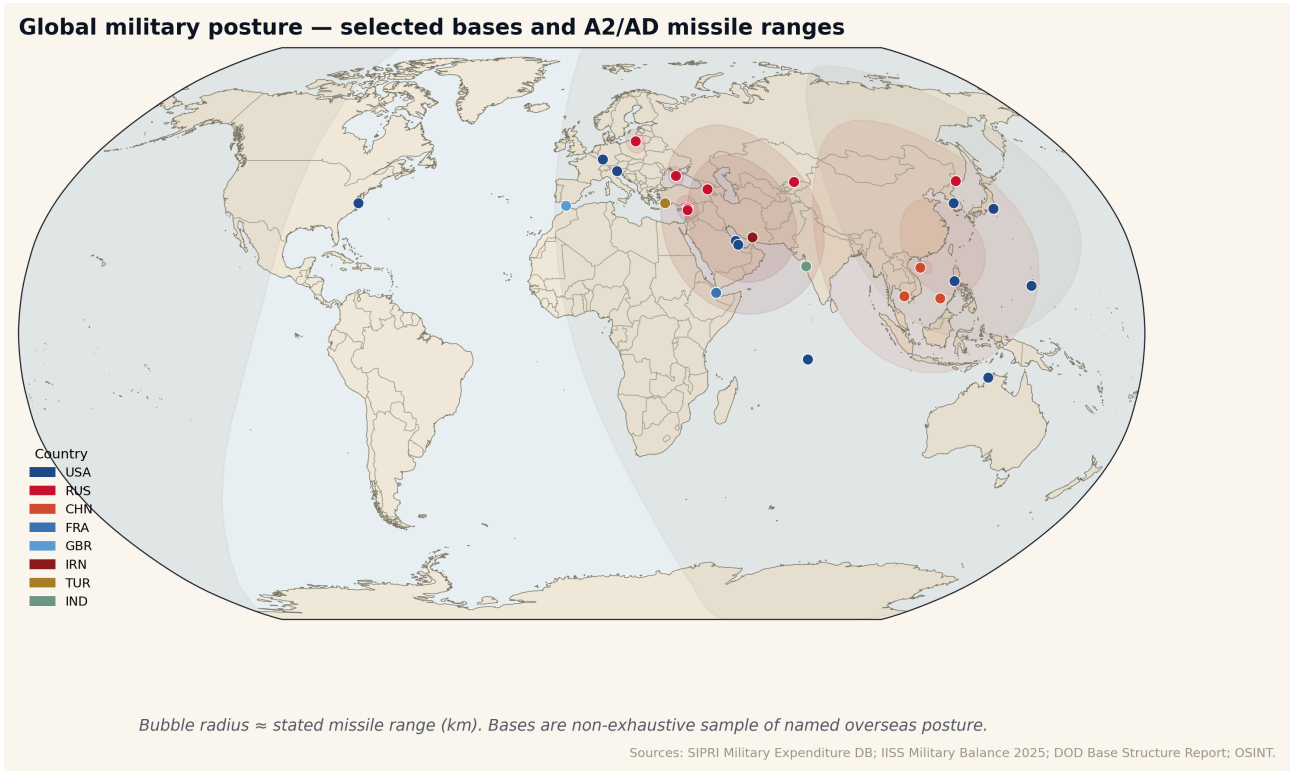


Exhibit 15.5 — Selected military bases and A2/AD missile-range bubbles.

Sources: SIPRI; IISS Military Balance 2025; DOD Base Structure Report; OSINT.

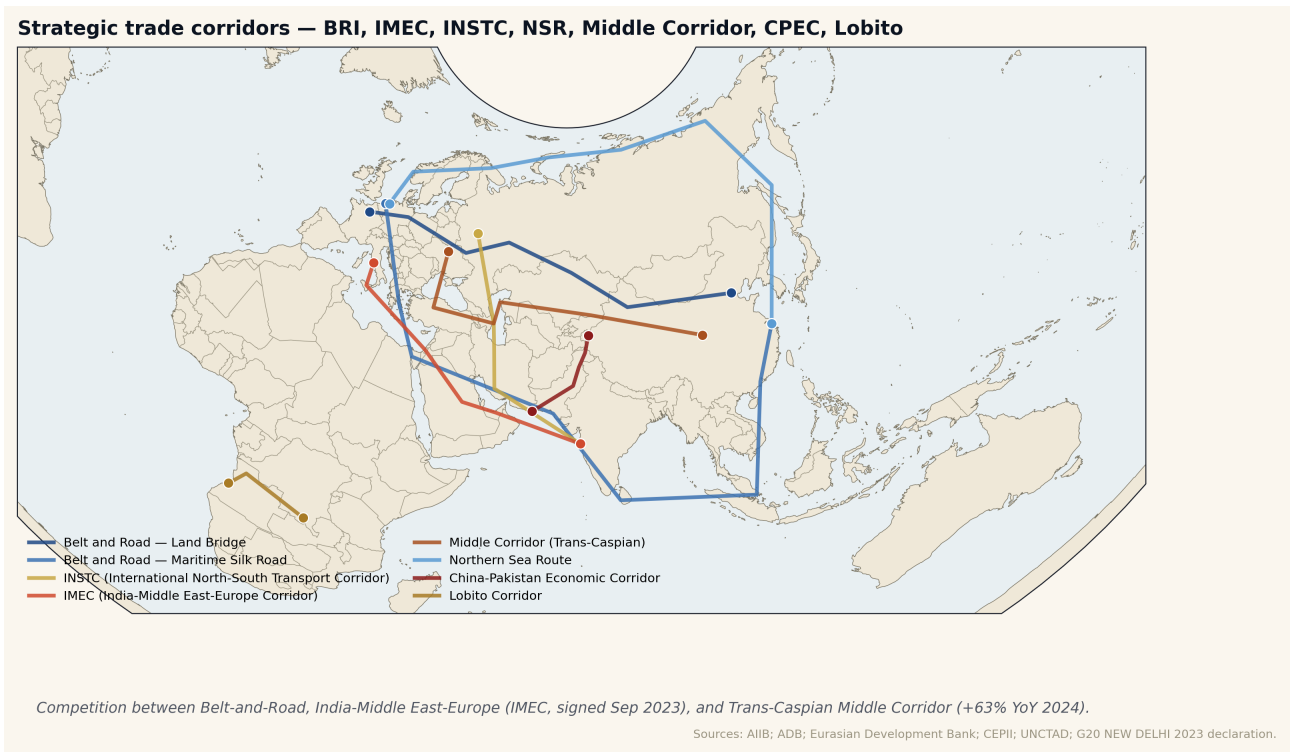


Exhibit 15.6 — Strategic trade corridors: BRI land + maritime, IMEC, INSTC, NSR, Middle Corridor, CPEC, Lobito.

Sources: AIIB; ADB; Eurasian Development Bank; CEPIL; UNCTAD.

Methodology & Limits

How this brief was produced; what it can and can't do.

How we built this brief
GIPRE v9.0 65-layer methodology (24 layers active in this 50-agent slice). 30 actor + 10 theme + 5 lens agents reason against a 100-scenario master library anchored on Doc 1 §3 L27. Every numeric claim sourced via OSINT (302 unique URL citations). Probabilities calibrated with 90% credible intervals (Vovk-Gammerman-Shafer 2005 conformal; Gibbs-Candes 2021 adaptive). SHA-256 manifest hash chain per Doc 1 L24. Reproducibility $\epsilon = 1e-6$. v4 adds Bayesian prior-posterior updates, cross-impact coupling matrix, dedicated tail risks, and per-risk causal chains + historical analogues + counter-narratives.

Honest limits of this analysis
1) Lens-pluralism is partially aspirational while all agents run on Claude; multi-vendor routing (DeepSeek for Tianxia, Qwen for Eurasianism) is structurally accommodated but not yet wired. 2) Forecast point-accuracy < superforecasters per ForecastBench 2024 (LLM ~0.13 Brier vs human superforecaster ~0.08). Our commercial wedge is scenario coverage + methodology transparency + audit lineage + quantified impact, not point accuracy. 3) No back-tested Brier track record yet — Q1-2026 cycle is the first.

R

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About GIPRE

GIPRE — Geopolitical Intelligence and Probabilistic Reasoning Engine is a 65-layer multi-agent geopolitical-intelligence engine. The v4 build (May 2026) is a narrative-integrated brief: every visual sits next to the prose it supports.

Theoretical pluralism. Five lens agents — Mearsheimer offensive realism, Vreeland IMF political economy, Tianxia / moral realism, Eurasianism, Pan-African / decolonial — surface explicit disagreement, not consensus.

Quantified business impact. Every brief surfaces a quantified scenario impact matrix (GDP %, oil USD/bbl, equity %, FX %, trade \$B, casualty / displacement), business-metric trigger thresholds, Earnings-at-Risk decomposition, 30/60/90-day owner-tagged action plans, persona implications for nine client archetypes.

Depth. Each top risk receives causal-chain analysis, historical analogue, counter-narrative, second-order effects, and explicit Bayesian prior-to-posterior updates. Tail risks (wild cards + black swans) get their own dedicated section.

Calibration. Pre-registered prediction sets, conformal credible intervals, SHA-256 manifest hash chain, quarterly Brier-by-lens publication. Reproducibility $\epsilon = 1e-6$.

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